

Irrationality of Cubic Threefolds after One Stabilization

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Abstract

We prove that $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is irrational for every smooth complex cubic threefold X , and deduce the same conclusion for every smooth prime Fano threefold of genus eight. The proof constructs an occurrence-indexed ledger of generic even quantum D -module blocks. Blowup and projective-bundle decompositions give its operation laws, while weak factorization turns folds that vanish on low-dimensional centers into birational invariants. A rank-two formal-exponent marker vanishes for points, curves, and surfaces, but detects $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ and separates it from $\mathbf{P}^4$. A finer framed fold has value 2 on X and 4 on $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$; under two explicit reconstruction hypotheses it gives a second birational obstruction. Finally, an integral six-axis construction proves universal CH_0 -triviality for every smooth member of the nonstandard A_5 -invariant cubic pencil. Their products with $\mathbf{P}^1$ remain universally CH_0 -trivial but are irrational, giving an explicit non-isotrivial family on which universal CH_0 -triviality and irrationality after one stabilization coexist.

Keywords. cubic threefold; universal CH_0 -triviality; irrationality; quantum D -modules; categorical markers; intermediate Jacobian; formal monodromy; weak factorization.

1 Introduction

A smooth projective variety is universally CH_0 -trivial if the degree map

$$\deg : CH_0(Y_L) \longrightarrow \mathbf{Z}$$

is an isomorphism for every field extension $L/\mathbf{C}$. This condition is a central consequence of stable rationality, and its failure is a standard stable-rationality obstruction. Its validity, however, need not provide a rational parametrization. We prove that even after one explicit stabilization it does not predict rationality for smooth cubic threefolds.

Theorem 1.1 (One-step irrationality). *For every smooth complex cubic threefold X , the fourfold $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is irrational.*

The birational argument is organized around one blowup. Restrict the quantum D -module (QDM) to the even-cohomology carrier over the even bulk base, split it over an algebraic closure of its generic coefficient field, and place the resulting formal connection blocks in a free commutative monoid. A marker is any monoid-valued fold of this block ledger. Iritani's blowup theorem identifies the marker of the blowup with the marker of the ambient variety plus the occurrence-indexed markers of the center; Iritani–Koto gives the parallel projective-bundle formula. Consequently, if the center markers vanish in dimensions at most $d - 2$, weak factorization makes the marker birationally invariant for smooth projective d -folds.

For the unconditional specialization, a block is marked when its rank is two, its centered leading Euler operator is nonzero nilpotent, and its canonical elementary modification has

two distinct formal exponent classes modulo $\mathbf{Z}$. Pairing horizontality makes the modification regular, and flatness makes the residue move by conjugation. Beauville’s small quantum algebra yields exponents $-1/6$ and $-5/6$, whose difference is nonintegral; equivalently, their squared separation is

$$\delta^\# = \frac{4}{9},$$

while the marker vanishes for every point, curve, and surface. The projective-bundle formula gives a nonzero value on $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$, whereas $\mathbf{P}^4$ has value zero. The categorical ledger theorem therefore proves Theorem 1.1.

The conclusion propagates immediately through stabilized birational correspondences. In particular, if $Y \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is birational to $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ for a smooth cubic threefold X , then $Y \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is irrational. Kuznetsov’s construction for a smooth prime Fano threefold V of genus eight gives rank-two projective bundles $\mathbf{P}_V(U)$ and $\mathbf{P}_X(E^*)$ related by a flop [25, Theorems 2.17–2.18]; hence $V \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is birational to $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ and is also irrational. The finer equality $\nu_6(V) = 2$ below remains conditional on the reconstruction-tail and divisor-tagging hypotheses of Section 5.

Unconditional separation results

Each separation statement rests on two independent inputs. Irrationality comes from the cubic direct-QDM marker. Universal CH_0 -triviality is proved for the same cubic by a classical or cycle-theoretic theorem, and then passes to the product by the projective-bundle formula for Chow groups. Thus the vanishing of the usual decomposition-of-the-diagonal obstruction and the quantum marker read genuinely different structures on the same fourfold.

Universally CH_0 -trivial cubic threefolds are known in abundance. Voisin proves that the ten-dimensional moduli space of smooth cubic threefolds contains a nonempty countable union of subvarieties of codimension at most three parametrizing threefolds with universally trivial CH_0 [35, Theorem 4.5].

Corollary 1.2 (Separation in codimension three). *There is a nonempty countable union of subvarieties of codimension at most three in the moduli space of smooth cubic threefolds such that, for every member X , both X and $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ are universally CH_0 -trivial, while $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is irrational.*

Independently, Colliot-Thélène proves that a smooth cubic hypersurface whose equation is a sum of forms in separated groups of at most three variables is universally CH_0 -trivial [14], which applies to the Fermat equation directly.

Corollary 1.3 (Fermat). *The fourfold*

$$\{x_1^3 + x_2^3 + x_3^3 + x_4^3 + x_5^3 = 0\} \times \mathbf{P}^1$$

is universally CH_0 -trivial and irrational.

Yang–Yu–Zhu construct a two-dimensional family of smooth cubic threefolds admitting unirational parametrizations of degrees two and three [38, Theorems 1.1 and 3.3]. Parametrizations of coprime degrees give a decomposition of the diagonal, so every member of that family is universally CH_0 -trivial; the same degrees persist on $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ [38, Corollary 3.5].

Corollary 1.4 (Coprime-degree cubics). *Let X be one of the cubic threefolds of [38, Theorem 3.3]. Then $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ admits unirational parametrizations of coprime degrees, is universally CH_0 -trivial, and is irrational.*

Yang–Yu–Zhu ask whether a variety with unirational parametrizations of coprime degrees can fail to be stably rational [38, Question 1.4]. Corollary 1.4 settles the first nontrivial stabilization for their examples. It does not settle stable irrationality: the marker and center-nullity theorem used here is an $m = 1$ statement and has no asserted higher-stabilization consequence.

For our second separation result we give a different uniform proof of universal CH_0 -triviality along the nonstandard A_5 -invariant pencil. There the primitive minimal class of the intermediate Jacobian is algebraic by an integral saturation theorem for the six-axis lattice, for every member at once. This construction also reaches beyond the separated-variable criterion of Colliot-Thélène: every moduli point represented by the pencil except the Fermat point fails to be projectively equivalent to a cubic of separated-variable type.

Theorem 1.5 (Separation on the A_5 -pencil). *Let W_5 be the five-dimensional irreducible A_5 -module, and let B° be the smooth locus inside*

$$\mathbf{P}((\mathrm{Sym}^3 W_5^*)^{A_5}).$$

For the resulting family $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow B^\circ$ and every $b \in B^\circ(\mathbf{C})$,

$$\mathcal{X}_b \text{ and } \mathcal{X}_b \times \mathbf{P}^1 \text{ are universally } CH_0\text{-trivial,}$$

and $\mathcal{X}_b \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is irrational. The family is non-isotrivial in coarse moduli. Exactly one point of its coarse-moduli image is represented by a cubic whose defining form is a sum of cubic forms in pairwise disjoint nonempty groups of at most three variables, namely the Fermat point.

The invariant cubic space in Theorem 1.5 is two-dimensional. Indeed, the character of W_5 is $(5, 1, -1, 0, 0)$ on the classes $1, 2A, 3A, 5A, 5B$, and the symmetric-cube character formula gives

$$\dim(\mathrm{Sym}^3 W_5^*)^{A_5} = 2.$$

Thus its projectivization is a pencil with connected smooth locus B° . Its coarse-moduli image is Hartlieb’s M_{H_1} ; this is not the component associated with $\mathbf{1} \oplus W_4$ [20, Lemma 5.5]. Since the family is non-isotrivial, its image in coarse moduli is a curve, one dimension below the locus of [38].

Remark 1.6. The pencil contains the Fermat cubic threefold; it is one of the two members that also admit the permutation action of A_5 [20, Lemma 5.5]. The mechanism is that W_5 is induced from a nontrivial cubic character χ of a point stabilizer $A_4 \subset A_5$: Frobenius reciprocity gives

$$\langle \mathrm{Ind}_{A_4}^{A_5} \chi, W_5 \rangle = \langle \chi, \mathrm{Res}_{A_4} W_5 \rangle = 1,$$

and both sides have dimension five, so $\mathrm{Ind}_{A_4}^{A_5} \chi \cong W_5$. Induction from a character realizes W_5 by monomial matrices whose nonzero entries are cube roots of unity, and such a matrix fixes $x_1^3 + \cdots + x_5^3$. Corollary 1.3 is therefore the member of Theorem 1.5 at which universal CH_0 -triviality is also classical, and Yang–Yu–Zhu give that member an explicit degree-three unirational parametrization [38, Remark 3.6].

A finer conditional framed invariant

The unconditional proof above is deliberately minimal: its marker retains only rank, generic nilpotence, and the two formal exponent classes modulo $\mathbf{Z}$. A second instance of the ledger construction, on a framed block type, retains finer data from the entire numerical small

even quantum connection. Definition 5.1 counts the primitive-sixth eigenvalues of framed formal monodromy on the original loop disc and gives an invariant ν_6 . The cubic packet calculation is unconditional and yields $\nu_6(X) = 2$. The product formula for Gromov–Witten theory gives $\nu_6(T \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 2\nu_6(T)$, so $\nu_6(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 4$ unconditionally.

The actual Iritani and Iritani–Koto comparison isomorphisms preserve the original- z -disc framing after coefficient extension. The string and divisor equations exactly remove the scalar degree-zero and fixed degree-two pieces of their reconstruction coordinates. We therefore split the remaining uncertainty into two statements in Section 5: Hypothesis 5.7R concerns only the residual reconstruction tail, while Hypothesis 5.7T is the separate specialization step in the divisor-tagging argument. The latter is already unnecessary for nef-canonical targets, for $\mathbf{P}^1$ and $\mathbf{P}^2$, for every rational geometrically ruled surface—for the Hirzebruch surface F_1 , on specializations satisfying a mild condition that every blowup center satisfies—and, assuming 5.7R, for ruled surfaces over positive-genus curves; in the present low-dimensional proof it remains only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. A rank-two formal-germ theorem proves the local mechanism needed for the cubic packet, but we do not identify the reconstruction value with a point of that formal germ.

Conditional on Hypothesis 5.7R, ν_6 satisfies the displayed projective-bundle and blowup formulas. Conditional on Hypothesis 5.7R and on Hypothesis 5.7T for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled, it is birationally invariant through dimension four. That invariance reproves the one-step conclusion from the finer invariant.

Theorem 1.7 (One-step irrationality from the framed invariant). *Assume Hypothesis 5.7R of Section 5, and Hypothesis 5.7T there only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. Let X be a smooth complex cubic threefold. Then $\nu_6(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 4$, every rational smooth projective fourfold has $\nu_6 = 0$, and consequently $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is irrational.*

Theorem 1.7 is not the logical basis of Theorem 1.1: it is a finer specialization of the common ledger theorem and reaches the same conclusion under two hypotheses. At the threefold level it refines the direct marker’s presence-or-absence value to an exact multiplicity, and for genus eight it gives the conditional identity $\nu_6(V) = 2$.

Relation with earlier rationality results

Clemens and Griffiths proved that every smooth complex cubic threefold is irrational by means of its intermediate Jacobian $J(X)$ [10]. The direct Clemens–Griffiths mechanism no longer yields a contradiction after one stabilization. Indeed,

$$H^3(X \times \mathbf{P}^1, \mathbf{Q}) \simeq H^3(X, \mathbf{Q}), \quad H^4(X \times \mathbf{P}^1, \mathbf{Q}) \simeq \mathbf{Q}(-2)^{\oplus 2}.$$

In a birational factorization of a fourfold, smooth surface centers may occur, and blowing up such a surface S contributes $H^1(S, \mathbf{Q})(-1)$ to H^3 . For the cubic itself, the Fano surface of lines $F(X)$ satisfies $\text{Alb}(F(X)) \simeq J(X)$ [10, Theorem 11.19], hence $H^1(F(X), \mathbf{Q})(-1) \simeq H^3(X, \mathbf{Q})$. Thus the surviving weight-three Hodge structure is already realizable as the H^1 of a smooth surface, exactly the form that a surface center may contribute, while the middle H^4 is Tate. The standard intermediate-Jacobian and blowup bookkeeping therefore gives no contradiction here, though this does not exclude more elaborate classical Hodge-theoretic obstructions. The direct-QDM marker instead follows the rank-two quantum spectral block and its modified residue.

For comparison, Guéré obtains a projective-K3-type Hodge necessary condition for rational cubic fourfolds from evaluated quantum data [19], while Benedetti–Fay–Guéré–Manivel–Perrin prove a monodromy/coarse-atom irrationality criterion for certain Hodge-general

Fano fourfolds with large vanishing middle H^4 [8]. Their hypotheses include $b_3 = 0$, so the criterion does not cover $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$, where $b_3 = 10$, the middle H^4 is Tate, and the surviving H^3 is already of surface-center type; the proof below instead uses the modified residue of the cubic even QDM block.

The very general cubic threefold is now known to be stably irrational [15, Corollary 1.4], but stable rationality remains open for an arbitrary smooth cubic threefold. Cai recently recovered irrationality from the primitive-sixth-root formal monodromy of the cubic quantum connection [9]; the small quantum algebra from which the cubic connection is derived was computed by Beauville [5]. Iritani and Iritani–Koto prove the quantum D -module decompositions for blowups and projective bundles [22, 24]. We apply their decompositions directly to the block marker and derive the cubic matrix and both of its markers from Beauville’s relations.

On the cycle side, Voisin reduces universal CH_0 -triviality of a cubic threefold to algebraicity of the primitive minimal class of its intermediate Jacobian [35]. Beckmann–de Gaay Fortman place such minimal classes in a general integral-Fourier framework [3]. For the very general cubic threefold the minimal class is not algebraic: every curve class on the intermediate Jacobian is an even multiple of it, so a very general cubic threefold admits no decomposition of the diagonal [15, Theorem 1.3 and Corollary 1.4]. Known pieces of the algebraic locus include Voisin’s components of codimension at most three, the almost-diagonal cubics of [14], and the coprime-degree family of [38]. Theorem 3.5 places the nonstandard A_5 -curve in the same algebraic-minimal-class locus by a uniform integral argument, and Proposition 3.13 shows that every moduli point on that pencil except the Fermat point lies outside the separated-variable locus covered by [14]. Thus for a general member the six-axis construction accounts for universal CH_0 -triviality in a case not covered by that criterion. Proposition 3.11 places every moduli point of that pencil except the Fermat point outside the explicit family of [38, Theorem 3.3] as well: every member of their normal form carries an Eckardt point, and every member of the pencil but two carries none. On Voisin’s side, Proposition 2.5 shows that the intermediate Jacobian of the geometric generic member receives no odd-degree isogeny from a product of elliptic curves, although it is isogenous to the fifth power of an elliptic curve; her construction of components therefore does not reach this pencil through a product of factors of dimension at most three. We do not claim that the A_5 -curve is disjoint from her locus. That would need both of the routes left open there to fail: no four-dimensional factor admitted by Proposition 2.5 may be the Jacobian of an irreducible curve of genus four, and the intermediate Jacobian must not be odd-degree isogenous to the Jacobian of an irreducible curve of genus five.

Proof map

Section 2 computes the six-axis polarization, identifies the exotic cubic gluing as the discriminant orientation of elliptic two-division, and draws from it the restriction on product factorizations of the intermediate Jacobian. Section 3 proves the local divisor-product theorem, applies it to the primitive minimal class, and shows that the resulting A_5 -curve is generically outside both the separated-variable locus and the explicit coprime-degree family. Section 4 proves the occurrence-indexed categorical ledger theorem, specializes it to the rank-two formal-exponent marker, and proves Theorem 1.1 unconditionally. Its Beauville-derived cubic block is isolated for reuse. Section 5 defines the finer invariant ν_6 , identifies it as a second instance of the ledger theorem on a framed block type, proves exact low-degree shift and projective-space product formulas, records the formal-germ rank-two rigidity theorem and the two residual hypotheses, and computes $\nu_6(X) = 2$ and $\nu_6(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 4$ from the same cubic packet. The final section combines the unconditional irrationality theo-

rem with the cycle-theoretic results and records the exact scope of the conditional framed refinement.

2 The six-axis polarization and the exotic packet

Let Ω be the six conjugate D_5 -subgroups of A_5 , equivalently the six Sylow-5 subgroups with their normalizers, and put

$$H_p = \text{Aug}(\mathbf{F}_p^\Omega) / \langle \mathbf{1} \rangle \quad (p = 2, 3).$$

We record the modular representation calculation used throughout the six-axis argument, so that the commutants do not have to be inferred from a table.

Lemma 2.1 (The six-point hearts). *For $p = 2, 3$, the $\mathbf{F}_p A_5$ -module H_p is simple, and*

$$\text{End}_{A_5}(H_2) = \mathbf{F}_4, \quad \text{End}_{A_5}(H_3) = \mathbf{F}_3.$$

Proof. Identify the six-point action with that of $A_5 \simeq \text{PSL}_2(\mathbf{F}_5)$ on $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_5)$, whose points are $\infty, 0, 1, 2, 3, 4$; the stabilizer of a point is the normalizer of a Sylow-5 subgroup. Let $a(z) = z + 1$ and $s(z) = -1/z$, which generate $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbf{F}_5)$. In $H_p = \text{Aug}(\mathbf{F}_p^\Omega) / \langle \mathbf{1} \rangle$, use the classes of

$$e_\infty - e_4, \quad e_0 - e_4, \quad e_1 - e_4, \quad e_2 - e_4$$

as a basis. The two generators act, for $p = 2$, by

$$A_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad S_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix},$$

and, for $p = 3$, by

$$A_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 2 & 2 & 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad S_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 2 & 2 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

In both characteristics A_p has minimal polynomial $\Phi_5(t) = t^4 + t^3 + t^2 + t + 1$, which is irreducible over $\mathbf{F}_p$ because the order of p in $(\mathbf{Z}/5\mathbf{Z})^\times$ is four. Hence any nonzero A_5 -stable subspace, being A_p -stable, is all of H_p ; thus H_p is simple.

It remains to compute the commutant. Solving the linear equations $XA_p = A_pX$ and $XS_p = S_pX$ gives only scalar matrices for $p = 3$. For $p = 2$ it gives the two-dimensional algebra spanned by I and

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad T^2 + T + I = 0.$$

Thus the two commutants are $\mathbf{F}_3$ and $\mathbf{F}_2[T]/(T^2 + T + 1) = \mathbf{F}_4$, respectively. This agrees with the modular matrix tables in [21]. $\square$

The six axes arise from the Fano surface. Let S be the Fano surface of a smooth member of the A_5 -pencil and $(J, \Theta) = \text{Alb}(S)$ its intermediate Jacobian. Each of the six D_5 -subgroups gives an elliptic quotient $q_H : J \rightarrow E_H^{\text{quot}}$ and its Rosati dual $i_H^{\text{quot}} : E_H^{\text{quot}} \rightarrow J$. **Generic non-CM axis.** Hartlieb's elliptic isogeny factor, and hence every six-axis elliptic quotient, is non-CM at the geometric generic point of the pencil. Indeed, a CM endomorphism has a fixed imaginary-quadratic order, so the generic j -invariant is a root of its Hilbert class polynomial and is constant. After a finite base change the elliptic factor would then be isotrivial. Hartlieb's isogeny $J_b \sim E_b^5$ would put the whole intermediate-Jacobian family in the countable isogeny class of one fixed abelian variety. The image of an algebraic curve in a moduli space cannot be both positive-dimensional and countable: its image is constructible, and a positive-dimensional constructible subset contains a nonempty Zariski-open subset of an algebraic curve, hence has uncountably many complex points. This contradicts the fact that the closure of the intermediate-Jacobian image is a one-dimensional special subvariety [20, Proposition 5.7 and Remark 5.8]. Since the generic intermediate Jacobian is isotypic to E_b^5 , each nonzero elliptic quotient is isogenous to E_b , and so is non-CM as well. This is a statement about the geometric generic point, not about every member: individual fibres may have complex multiplication, and there the divisor lattice selected by the marked presentation can be smaller than the full Neron–Severi lattice. Those fibres are covered by the prescribed-lattice reading of Theorem 3.3 recorded after its proof.

Proposition 2.2 (Generic six-axis polarization). *On the geometric generic fibre of the nonstandard A_5 -pencil, after coherent identification of the six quotient elliptic curves, the Rosati Gram matrix of the six maps is*

$$G_6 = 6I_6 - J_6.$$

Any five axes therefore give a generic-fibre isogeny $E^5 \rightarrow J$ whose pulled-back polarization has Smith type $(1, 6, 6, 6, 6)$.

Proof. The geometric generic elliptic factor has only integer endomorphisms. We recall the numerical passage from Roulleau's genus-two configuration to the six elliptic fibres. Let $D_g \subset S$ be the curve indexed by an involution $g \in A_5$, put $D_{\text{tot}} = \sum_g D_g$, and, for a dihedral subgroup H of order ten, put

$$F_H = \sum_{g \in H, g^2=1} D_g.$$

Roulleau proves that F_H is a fibre of $S \rightarrow E_H^{\text{quot}}$ [30, Theorem 11(D)], so $F_H^2 = 0$. His intersection table has $D_g^2 = -4$, and distinct curves meet with multiplicity zero, two, or one when the product of their labels has order two, three, or five, respectively; Lemma 14 proves that these values are constant in the corresponding families [30, Lemma 14, Corollary 16, and (3.1)]. Among the 105 unordered pairs of involutions, the product orders two, three, and five occur 15, 30, 60 times. Hence

$$D_{\text{tot}}^2 = 15(-4) + 2(30 \cdot 2 + 60 \cdot 1) = 180.$$

Every involution belongs to two of the six dihedral subgroups, and therefore $\sum_H F_H = 2D_{\text{tot}}$. Two-transitivity on the six subgroups now gives

$$30(F_H \cdot F_{H'}) = (2D_{\text{tot}})^2 = 720, \quad F_H \cdot F_{H'} = 24 \quad (H \neq H').$$

By the preceding generic non-CM argument, the elliptic factor has only integer endomorphisms. After coherent identification of the generic elliptic quotients, two-transitivity makes the Rosati matrix have diagonal d and off-diagonal m . Put

$$D_H = q_H^*[0] \in \text{NS}(J), \quad N_H = i_H^{\text{quot}} q_H \in \text{End}(J).$$

Then $D_H|_S = F_H$, and N_H is the Rosati endomorphism attached to D_H . Coherent identification gives $q_H i_H^{\text{quot}} = [d]$ and $q_H i_{H'}^{\text{quot}} = [m]$ for $H \neq H'$. Each target identification is determined only up to a sign, and the ambiguity changes nothing used here. Replacing the chosen isomorphism $E_H^{\text{quot}} \rightarrow E$ by its negative replaces q_H by $-q_H$ and, by functoriality of Rosati duality, i_H^{quot} by $-i_H^{\text{quot}}$ at the same time. Hence $N_H = i_H^{\text{quot}} q_H$ is unchanged, and so is $D_H = q_H^*[0]$, since $[-1]^*[0] = [0]$. The diagonal entry $q_H i_H^{\text{quot}}$ is likewise unchanged, while the Gram matrix changes by a signed congruence DG_6D with $D = \text{diag}(\pm 1)$, which alters neither the Smith type of the pulled-back polarization nor anything below. The coherent choice is the one making all off-diagonal entries equal; it is unique up to a global sign, which acts trivially. The invariant sum of the six axis maps vanishes because the five-dimensional constituent has no trivial summand; composing with q_H gives $d + 5m = 0$. The minimal-class identity $[S] = \Theta^3/3!$ [10], together with the polarized Riemann–Roch trace formula

$$\frac{\alpha\beta\Theta^{g-2}}{(g-2)!} = \text{tr}(N_\alpha)\text{tr}(N_\beta) - \text{tr}(N_\alpha N_\beta),$$

obtained by polarizing the reduced-norm Riemann–Roch polynomial [18, Theorem 4.1], gives the following identities. Here tr is the degree-five trace in the coefficient representation, the trace entering that reduced norm, rather than the degree-ten trace on rational first homology:

$$\text{tr}(N_H) = d, \quad \text{tr}(N_H N_{H'}) = m^2, \quad F_H F_{H'} = d^2 - m^2.$$

Thus $d^2 - m^2 = 24$. Together with $d + 5m = 0$ and $d > 0$, this forces $(d, m) = (5, -1)$, hence $G_6 = 6I - J$. A five-by-five minor has Smith form $(1, 6, 6, 6, 6)$. $\square$

Let B° be the connected smooth locus of the nonstandard A_5 -pencil, and let $\mathcal{J} \rightarrow B^\circ$ be its relative intermediate Jacobian.

Lemma 2.3 (Relative six-axis source). *There are an elliptic scheme $\mathcal{E} \rightarrow B^\circ$ and a relative isogeny*

$$f : \mathcal{A} := \mathcal{E} \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}} (\mathbf{Z}^\Omega / \mathbf{Z}\mathbf{1}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{J}$$

which is A_5 -equivariant. The quotient lattice carries the form induced by $6I_6 - J_6$; both the source and this form carry their natural S_6 -action. Moreover,

$$f^* \lambda_\Theta = \lambda_{\mathcal{A}}. \tag{2.1}$$

After omitting one axis, $\mathcal{A} \simeq \mathcal{E}^5$ and this form has matrix $6I_5 - J_5$. For $p = 2, 3$, put $\mathcal{V}_p = \mathcal{E}[p]$. The p -primary kernel of the source polarization has a natural A_5 -equivariant symplectic description

$$\mathcal{D}_p \simeq H_p \otimes_{\mathbf{F}_p} \mathcal{V}_p \quad (p = 2, 3). \tag{2.2}$$

The p -primary part $\mathcal{K}_p$ of $\ker f$ is an A_5 -stable relative maximal isotropic subgroup of $\mathcal{D}_p$.

Proof. For $H \in \Omega$, the integral norm $n_H = \sum_{h \in H} h$ is a relative endomorphism of $\mathcal{J}$. Its action on rational first homology is ten times the projector onto the H -fixed summand. Fibrewise, Hartlieb’s character calculation and isogeny decomposition give $H^1(J, \mathbf{Q}) \simeq W_5 \otimes H^1(E, \mathbf{Q})$, and hence the self-product of an elliptic curve through the five-dimensional module W_5 [20, Lemma 5.5 and Remark 5.8]. Since $\dim W_5^H = 1$, the fixed summand has rank two. More concretely, $n_H^2 = 10n_H$. The scheme-theoretic image of a homomorphism of abelian schemes in characteristic zero is an abelian subscheme, and its quotient factorization commutes with base change [2, Theorem A]. That citation supplies the abelian-scheme structure; the relative dimension is pinned by $n_H^2 = 10n_H$, which makes $n_H/10$ a projector, so on every fibre the image is the connected abelian subvariety it cuts out, of dimension

one by $\dim W_5^H = 1$. Thus the scheme-theoretic norm image $\mathcal{E}_H^{\text{im}} \subset \mathcal{J}$ is an elliptic scheme. Since $hn_H = n_H$ for every $h \in H$, the subgroup H acts trivially on $\mathcal{E}_H^{\text{im}}$. Moreover $N_{A_5}(H) = H$, so transport by an element carrying H to H' is independent of the chosen transporter. The six norm-image elliptic schemes are therefore coherently isomorphic; fix one of them as $\mathcal{E}$.

Write $i_H^{\text{im}} : \mathcal{E} \rightarrow \mathcal{J}$ for the transported primitive norm-image inclusions. On the geometric generic fibre, Hartlieb's isogeny decomposition identifies $\text{Hom}^0(E, J)$ with the irreducible module W_5 . The coherently transported maps $(i_H^{\text{im}})_{H \in \Omega}$ form one A_5 -orbit, so their sum is invariant. Since $W_5^{A_5} = 0$, that sum is zero. The connected smooth curve B° is integral, $\mathcal{E}$ is integral, and $\mathcal{J}$ is separated over B° . Two morphisms from an integral scheme to a separated one agree along a closed subscheme; here that subscheme contains the dense generic fibre, so $\sum_H i_H^{\text{im}}$ and the zero map agree everywhere and $\sum_H i_H^{\text{im}} = 0$ over B° . Hence $(i_H^{\text{im}})_{H \in \Omega}$ descends from $\mathcal{E}^\Omega$ to the displayed map $f : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{J}$, and the construction is A_5 -equivariant.

Roulleau constructs the D_5 -fibration from an Albanese quotient $q_H : J \rightarrow E_H^{\text{quot}}$ by a connected four-dimensional abelian subvariety [30, the sentence following Lemma 17 and the proof of Theorem 11(D)]. Thus $F_H = q_H^*[0]_S$. The connected kernel makes the Rosati dual of q_H a primitive inclusion, and its image is the unique H -fixed elliptic subvariety. It therefore agrees, up to an automorphism of the target elliptic curve, with the norm-image elliptic curve $\mathcal{E}_H^{\text{im}} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{J}$. This also identifies the norm-image axis, up to isogeny, with Hartlieb's generic elliptic isogeny factor. The quotient curve E_H^{quot} and the norm-image curve $\mathcal{E}_H^{\text{im}}$ are therefore kept distinct until this point; the Rosati dual identifies the latter with the image of the former, up to the target automorphism just described. Consequently the generic-fibre classes computed in Proposition 2.2 are the classes of these relative homomorphisms. They give diagonal entry 5 and off-diagonal entry -1 on the geometric generic fibre. Applying the same generic-density and separatedness argument to these homomorphisms gives the identities over B° , hence (2.1). Choosing any five coordinate classes identifies the quotient lattice with $\mathbf{Z}^5$, where its matrix is $6I_5 - J_5$. Since this has Smith type $(1, 6, 6, 6, 6)$, the source polarization is nondegenerate, so f is a finite flat isogeny. From $\lambda_{\mathcal{A}} = f^\vee \lambda_\Theta f$ one gets

$$|\ker \lambda_{\mathcal{A}}| = 6^8, \quad |\ker f| = \deg f = 6^4.$$

For $x, y \in \ker f$, functoriality of the polarization commutator pairing gives $e_{\lambda_{\mathcal{A}}}(x, y) = e_{\lambda_\Theta}(fx, fy) = 1$. Thus $\ker f$ is isotropic and has square-root order in $\ker \lambda_{\mathcal{A}}$, hence is maximal isotropic. Its p -primary part has fibrewise order p^4 for $p = 2, 3$.

For $p = 2, 3$, the primary discriminant local system is

$$\mathcal{D}_p = \ker(6I_6 - J_6 : \mathcal{A}[p] \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}^\vee[p]).$$

Modulo p , the radical quotient of the induced coefficient form is canonically

$$\text{Aug}(\mathbf{F}_p^\Omega) / \langle \mathbf{1} \rangle = H_p.$$

The form on this coefficient discriminant is the normalized form

$$b_p(\bar{x}, \bar{y}) = \frac{1}{p} x^\dagger (6I_6 - J_6) y \pmod{p} = \begin{cases} \bar{x} \cdot \bar{y}, & p = 2, \\ -\bar{x} \cdot \bar{y}, & p = 3. \end{cases} \quad (2.3)$$

For augmentation lifts, the product of the coordinate sums is divisible by p^2 , which proves the displayed formulas. They are unchanged by adding the constant vector or p times an integral vector. The dot product on the augmentation module has radical exactly the

constant line, so b_p is nondegenerate on H_p ; b_2 is alternating and b_3 is symmetric. Tensoring with the Weil pairing on $\mathcal{V}_p$ gives (2.2) as a symplectic isomorphism. Since f is A_5 -equivariant, each $\mathcal{K}_p$ is A_5 -stable. The preceding order and isotropy calculation makes it a relative maximal isotropic subgroup of this rank-eight local system. $\square$

Consequently the generic Gram calculation of Proposition 2.2 extends, by the relative homomorphisms and separatedness in Lemma 2.3, to every smooth fibre of the pencil. Thus every smooth fibre has six-axis Rosati matrix $6I_6 - J_6$, and any five axes have Smith type $(1, 6, 6, 6, 6)$.

Proposition 2.4 (Principal gluing packet). *The A_5 -stable two-primary principal kernels of the six-axis source are parametrized by*

$$\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_4) = \mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_2) \sqcup \{\omega, \omega^2\}.$$

The three $\mathbf{F}_2$ -rational kernels are S_6 -stable. Each of the other two has stabilizer exactly A_5 , and the outer normalizer exchanges them. The intermediate Jacobian of the nonstandard A_5 -cubic component uses the latter pair. In the relative packet, monodromy on this exotic pair is the sign of its permutation action on the three rational kernels. Thus the exotic pair represents the orientation, or discriminant, class of the rational degree-three cover. The relative kernel selects one exotic sheet, so the mod-two monodromy of $\mathcal{E}$ is contained in $A_3 \simeq C_3$. The A_5 -stable three-primary kernels form $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_3)$; after choosing a complementary symplectic ruling, each is a scalar graph.

Proof. At two, by Lemma 2.1, the coefficient discriminant is the simple four-dimensional $\mathbf{F}_2 A_5$ -module H_2 , whose commutant is $\mathbf{F}_4$. The full discriminant is the semisimple module $H_2 \otimes_{\mathbf{F}_2} \mathbf{F}_2^2 \simeq H_2^{\oplus 2}$. Every stable half is therefore one copy of H_2 , and Schur's lemma identifies such submodules with the one-dimensional $\mathbf{F}_4$ -subspaces of $\mathbf{F}_4^2$. This gives $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_4)$.

Here is the polarization check explicitly. Identify the coefficient heart with the natural two-dimensional $\mathbf{F}_4$ -module. The trace-determinant form is a nonzero invariant alternating form. Relative to it, the normalized form b_2 of (2.3) differs by a nonzero scalar in $\mathbf{F}_4$; rescaling an $\mathbf{F}_4$ -basis absorbs that scalar because squaring permutes $\mathbf{F}_4^\times$. We may therefore put

$$b(x, y) = \text{Tr}_{\mathbf{F}_4/\mathbf{F}_2} \det(x, y).$$

On two multiplicity copies use

$$\Omega((x, y), (x', y')) = b(x, y') + b(y, x').$$

Every scalar $a \in \mathbf{F}_4$ is self-adjoint for b , since $b(ax, y) = b(x, ay)$. Thus the vertical line and all four graphs Γ_a are isotropic of half dimension. The five module-theoretic possibilities are exactly the five polarized gluings; no further quadratic condition removes the exotic pair.

The simplex group acts on both multiplicity copies of the coefficient heart over $\mathbf{F}_2$. Hence the three lines defined over $\mathbf{F}_2$ retain S_6 . The stabilizer of an exotic graph is equally intrinsic. A permutation that fixes Γ_ω commutes with ω , hence is $\mathbf{F}_4$ -linear on the two-dimensional $\mathbf{F}_4$ -space H_2 . If its determinant is $d \in \mathbf{F}_4^\times$, preservation of b says

$$\text{Tr}_{\mathbf{F}_4/\mathbf{F}_2}(dz) = \text{Tr}_{\mathbf{F}_4/\mathbf{F}_2}(z) \quad (z \in \mathbf{F}_4).$$

The trace pairing is nondegenerate, so $d = 1$. It therefore lies in $\text{SL}_2(4)$, of order 60. The given A_5 already has that order and lies in the stabilizer, proving equality. The odd coset

in its order-120 normalizer is semilinear and applies field Frobenius, so it exchanges ω and ω^2 .

To pass from the generic fibre to the family, put

$$\mathcal{P} = \mathbf{P}_{\mathbf{F}_4}(\mathbf{F}_4 \otimes_{\mathbf{F}_2} \mathcal{V}_2).$$

By Lemma 2.3, this is the five-sheet local system of A_5 -stable principal halves. It has the degree-three sub-local system $\mathcal{P}_{\text{rat}} = \mathbf{P}_{\mathbf{F}_2}(\mathcal{V}_2)$ and the degree-two complement $\mathcal{P}_{\text{ex}}$. Here H_2 , together with its commutant $\mathbf{F}_4$, is constant, while monodromy acts only on $\mathcal{V}_2$. Its action is therefore $\mathbf{F}_4$ -linear, not semilinear, and factors through $\text{GL}_2(\mathbf{F}_2)$; in particular it preserves both subsets. Identify $\text{GL}_2(\mathbf{F}_2)$ with the permutation group of $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_2)$. Its scalar extension lies in $\text{PGL}_2(\mathbf{F}_4) \simeq A_5$, so the permutation on the complementary pair has the same sign as that on the rational triple. The latter sign defines the orientation cover. Thus the two quadratic classes agree; their torsors are isomorphic in two ways, exchanged by the deck involution. The relative kernel $\mathcal{K}_2$ gives a section of $\mathcal{P}$.

At the geometric generic point this section cannot be rational. Otherwise the natural faithful S_6 -action on $\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{E} \otimes (\mathbf{Z}^\Omega / \mathbf{Z}^1)$, which is the identity on $\mathcal{E}$ tensored with the faithful permutation action on the quotient lattice, would preserve the rational kernel: under (2.2) it acts on H_2 and trivially on $\mathcal{V}_2$, so every member of $\mathcal{P}_{\text{rat}}$ is S_6 -stable. At three, Lemma 2.1 says that the analogous coefficient heart H_3 is simple and $\text{End}_{A_5}(H_3) = \mathbf{F}_3$. The semisimple module $H_3^{\oplus 2}$ has stable halves parametrized by $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_3)$. The tensor pairing is b_3 times the alternating multiplicity pairing, so the three affine scalar graphs and the vertical line are all maximal isotropic. The natural S_6 -action is the same on both multiplicity copies, so it fixes every one of these four lines. The dependency is thus: a rational two-primary half is S_6 -fixed, every three-primary half is S_6 -fixed, and $|\ker f| = 6^4$ makes the two primary parts exhaust $\ker f$. The full kernel would therefore be S_6 -stable, so each $s \in S_6$ would descend to $\bar{s} : J \rightarrow J$. The descended map preserves the principal polarization. Indeed s preserves $6I_6 - J_6$, hence $s^* \lambda_{\mathcal{A}} = \lambda_{\mathcal{A}}$, and

$$f^*(\bar{s}^* \lambda_{\Theta}) = s^* f^* \lambda_{\Theta} = s^* \lambda_{\mathcal{A}} = \lambda_{\mathcal{A}} = f^* \lambda_{\Theta},$$

while $\varphi \mapsto f^\vee \varphi f$ is injective on $\text{Hom}(J, J^\vee)$ because f is an isogeny; so $\bar{s}^* \lambda_{\Theta} = \lambda_{\Theta}$ and $\bar{s} \in \text{Aut}(J, \Theta)$. Everything here is a statement about polarization classes, so the translation and Appell–Humbert semicharacter choices that realize a class by an actual line bundle do not enter. The action would be faithful: if a source automorphism acts trivially on the quotient, the image of its difference from the identity is both connected and contained in the finite isogeny kernel, hence zero. Strong Torelli gives an exact sequence [20, Theorem 3.1]

$$1 \longrightarrow \{\pm 1\} \longrightarrow \text{Aut}(J, \Theta) \longrightarrow \text{Aut}(X) \longrightarrow 1.$$

The kernel of the resulting map from S_6 to $\text{Aut}(X)$ would be a normal subgroup of order at most two; it is trivial. Thus S_6 would act faithfully on a smooth cubic threefold. This contradicts the classification of faithful automorphism groups [20, Theorem 2.1]. Five of the six listed ambient groups have order smaller than $|S_6| = 720$. The remaining group is $(\mathbf{Z}/3\mathbf{Z})^4 \rtimes S_5$, of order 9720, which is not divisible by 720. None can contain S_6 . The section is therefore generically in $\mathcal{P}_{\text{ex}}$. Its inverse image is open and closed in the connected base B° , so every smooth fibre has exotic two-primary kernel. The section therefore trivializes the sign torsor over B° , so the preceding calculation gives $\rho_2(\pi_1(B^\circ)) \subseteq \ker(\text{sgn}) = A_3$. The same calculation at three gives the four lines parametrized by $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_3)$; choosing any complementary line as the vertical ruling makes the selected half an affine scalar graph. $\square$

On a Weierstrass chart $y^2 = x^3 + Ax + B$, the rational packet is the root cover of $x^3 + Ax + B$, while its orientation class is $u^2 = -4A^3 - 27B^2$. Since $\Delta_{\mathcal{E}} = 16(-4A^3 - 27B^2)$,

this is the square class of the elliptic discriminant. Invariantly, for the Hodge line λ , it is the class of the torsor of square roots in $\lambda^{\otimes 6}$ of the nowhere-vanishing discriminant section in $\lambda^{\otimes 12}$.

The companion paper [32] identifies this packet with the root and sign quotients of the S_3 -torsor on $\mathcal{E}[2]$ and gives its exact level-six modular realization; those refinements are not used below.

For the cycle-theoretic argument, the unordered pair is enough. Both members act on the heart with the same squarefree minimal polynomial $t^2 + t + 1$. Theorem 3.5 uses only the conclusion that the geometric kernel is not one of the three $\mathbf{F}_2$ -rational gluings. At three it uses only scalarity of the possible A_5 -stable graphs, not the finer monodromy selection.

Hartlieb proves that the closure of its intermediate-Jacobian image is a one-dimensional special subvariety [20, Proposition 5.7]. Since the cubic period map is a locally closed embedding, the resulting smooth family is non-isotrivial. Only this landing and nonconstancy are used below; no identification of compactified parameter curves is needed for the separation theorem.

The exotic kernel also limits how J can be assembled from lower-dimensional principally polarized pieces. Voisin's components of codimension at most three are produced by an odd-degree isogeny from the Jacobian of a possibly reducible curve [35, proof of Theorem 4.5]. A principally polarized abelian variety of dimension at most three is such a Jacobian, so the route is automatic whenever the intermediate Jacobian receives an odd-degree isogeny from a product of factors of dimension at most three under which the polarization pulls back to an odd multiple of the product polarization. Here it is not available.

Proposition 2.5 (No elliptic-product route). *Let J be the intermediate Jacobian of the geometric generic fibre of the nonstandard A_5 -pencil, let E be the geometric generic fibre of $\mathcal{E}$, and let*

$$\mu : \prod_{i=1}^k (A_i, \Theta_i) \longrightarrow (J, \Theta)$$

be an isogeny from a product of principally polarized abelian varieties with $\mu^\Theta = m \sum_i \Theta_i$; its degree is m^5 , since $\deg \lambda_{\mu^*\Theta} = (\deg \mu)^2 \deg \lambda_{\Theta}$ while $\deg \lambda_{m \sum_i \Theta_i} = m^{10}$, so the degree is odd exactly when m is. If m is odd then either $k = 1$, or $k = 2$ and the two factors have dimensions one and four. The second case occurs: every axis $H \in \Omega$ gives such a μ , with A_1 an elliptic curve isogenous to E . Finally, no product of five elliptic curves admits an odd-degree isogeny onto J at all, whatever the pullback of Θ , even though J is isogenous to E^5 .*

Proof. Write $\Lambda = \mathbf{Z}^\Omega / \mathbf{Z}\mathbf{1}$ with the symmetric form κ of matrix $6I_6 - J_6$ from Proposition 2.2, put $M = H_1(E, \mathbf{Z})$ and $L = H_1(J, \mathbf{Z})$, and let $\Lambda_1 = \Lambda^\vee \cap \frac{1}{2}\Lambda$, where $\Lambda^\vee$ is the κ -dual. Doubling identifies Λ_1/Λ with the kernel of κ modulo two inside $\Lambda/2\Lambda$, equivariantly, hence with the two-primary coefficient heart H_2 of (2.2); the $\mathbf{F}_4$ -scalars and the pairing b are transported along that identification. By Lemma 2.3, f_* identifies $H_1(\mathcal{A}, \mathbf{Z})$ on the geometric generic fibre with $\Lambda \otimes M \subseteq L$, with quotient $\ker f$, and the polarization form is the tensor product of κ with the symplectic form of M . Fix a basis of $M \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$. By Proposition 2.4 the two-primary kernel is one of the two exotic graphs, so in that basis

$$L \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2 = \{(u, u') \in (\Lambda_1 \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2)^{\oplus 2} : [u'] = \omega^{\pm 1}[u]\},$$

where $[\cdot]$ is the class in H_2 and ω is the $\mathbf{F}_4$ -scalar of order three.

At the geometric generic point E has no complex multiplication, so the endomorphism algebra of the weight-one Hodge structure $M_{\mathbf{Q}}$ is $\mathbf{Q}$. As $H_1(J, \mathbf{Q}) = W_5 \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}}$, every

sub-Hodge structure is $U \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}}$ for a subspace $U \subseteq W_5$, and two of them are orthogonal exactly when the subspaces are κ -orthogonal.

Let $U_i \subseteq W_5$ be the subspace with

$$\mu_* H_1(A_i, \mathbf{Q}) = U_i \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}},$$

and put $L' = \mu_*(\bigoplus_i H_1(A_i, \mathbf{Z}))$. It is the direct sum of sublattices of the sub-Hodge structures $L \cap (U_i \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}})$, and its index in L is odd because the degree of μ is, so localizing at two turns those inclusions into equalities: $L \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2 = \bigoplus_i P_i$ with $P_i = (L \cap (U_i \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}})) \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$. Under the polarization hypothesis the subspaces U_i are moreover κ -orthogonal, since $\mu^* \Theta = m \sum_i \Theta_i$ makes the polarization form block diagonal on $\bigoplus_i H_1(A_i, \mathbf{Z})$; the decomposition $L \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2 = \bigoplus_i P_i$ is then orthogonal and each P_i unimodular, and each summand of L' carries m times a unimodular alternating form. Apply the displayed description of $L \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$ in two ways. Its first-coordinate projection is all of $\Lambda_1 \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$ and carries P_i into $(\Lambda_1 \cap U_i) \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$; summing over i and comparing with that surjectivity gives $\Lambda_1 \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2 = \bigoplus_i (\Lambda_1 \cap U_i) \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$, with equality in each piece. Its intersection with the first coordinate subspace is $\Lambda \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$, and that subspace is the direct sum of its intersections with the $U_i \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}}$, so $\Lambda \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2 = \bigoplus_i (\Lambda \cap U_i) \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$. Hence $H_2 = \bigoplus_i H_2^{(i)}$ with $H_2^{(i)} = (\Lambda_1 \cap U_i)/(\Lambda \cap U_i)$. For $(u, u') \in P_i$ both classes lie in $H_2^{(i)}$ and, by that same projection, u runs over all of $\Lambda_1 \cap U_i$; so $\omega H_2^{(i)} \subseteq H_2^{(i)}$ and every summand is an $\mathbf{F}_4$ -subspace.

That decomposition is orthogonal for the trace-determinant pairing b used above, and H_2 has $\mathbf{F}_4$ -dimension two, so at most two summands are nonzero, with $\mathbf{F}_4$ -dimensions 2 and 0, or 1 and 1. The second pattern is impossible. An $\mathbf{F}_4$ -line $\ell = \mathbf{F}_4 x$ is totally isotropic for b , since $\det(x, ax) = a \det(x, x) = 0$, and b is nondegenerate, so $\ell^\perp = \ell$; two $\mathbf{F}_4$ -lines orthogonal to one another therefore coincide, and cannot be complementary. One summand consequently carries the whole heart. The discriminant group of a lattice of rank r needs at most r generators and H_2 needs four, so that summand has $\dim U_i \geq 4$. This leaves $k = 1$, or $k = 2$ with dimensions four and one.

For the second case let $v \in \Lambda$ be the class of an axis, so $\kappa(v, v) = 5$. As 5 is a unit at two, $\Lambda \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$ is the orthogonal sum of $\mathbf{Z}_2 v$ and $(\Lambda \cap v^\perp) \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$, and the first summand is unimodular, so the whole coefficient heart is carried by the second. By the same display, $L \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$ is then the orthogonal sum of the localizations of $L \cap (\mathbf{Q}v \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}})$ and $L \cap (v^\perp \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}})$, and both are unimodular, so the index of that sum in L is odd. On each summand the alternating form has odd elementary divisors $d_1 \mid \cdots \mid d_g$; passing to the sublattice spanned by $d_g e_i / d_i$ and f_i in a symplectic basis makes it d_g times a unimodular form, at the odd index $\prod_i (d_g / d_i)$. Taking m to be the product of the two resulting multipliers and shrinking each summand again by the complementary odd factor makes both forms m times a unimodular one. The first summand has rank two and gives an elliptic curve isogenous to E ; the second has rank eight.

For the last assertion drop the polarization hypothesis and let $\mu : \prod_{i=1}^5 E_i \rightarrow J$ be any isogeny of odd degree from a product of elliptic curves. The argument above through $H_2 = \bigoplus_i H_2^{(i)}$ with each summand ω -stable uses only that the index is odd – neither the orthogonality of the P_i nor their unimodularity enters it – so it applies. Each U_i is now a line, so the decompositions $\Lambda_1 \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2 = \bigoplus_i (\Lambda_1 \cap U_i) \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$ and $\Lambda \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2 = \bigoplus_i (\Lambda \cap U_i) \otimes \mathbf{Z}_2$ force $\Lambda_1 \cap U_i$ and $\Lambda \cap U_i$ to have rank one, and $H_2^{(i)} = (\Lambda_1 \cap U_i)/(\Lambda \cap U_i)$ is therefore cyclic; it is killed by two because $\Lambda_1 \subseteq \frac{1}{2}\Lambda$, and being $\mathbf{F}_4$ -stable it has even dimension over $\mathbf{F}_2$, hence vanishes. Then $H_2 = 0$, against $|H_2| = 16$. $\square$

Hartlieb records, in the footnote to [20, Remark 5.8], that van Geemen and Yamauchi split the intermediate Jacobian of a cubic threefold with an automorphism of order five, up

to isogeny, as an elliptic curve times the square of an abelian surface. The proposition is compatible with that: their splitting is an isogeny, and what fails here is its realization by an odd-degree isogeny matching the polarizations. Two routes into Voisin's construction therefore remain, one for each case of the proposition: a four-dimensional factor of the second case may be the Jacobian of an irreducible curve of genus four, or J itself may be odd-degree isogenous to the Jacobian of an irreducible curve of genus five. Both are open, so this pencil is not known to lie in one of those components. Remark 2.6 says which principally polarized fourfolds the first route ranges over, which is not immediate: the second case admits six of them, and the intrinsic factor they are isogenous to is not one. Section 3 does not depend on the question: the algebraicity of the primitive minimal class is proved there directly.

Remark 2.6 (Which fourfolds the second case admits). Fix an axis H with class v , so that $\kappa(v, v) = 5$, and let $N = v^\perp \subset \Lambda$. In the basis of the five remaining axes, $N = \{x \in \mathbf{Z}^5 : \sum x_i = 0\}$ carries the form $6\langle x, y \rangle$: six times the A_4 root lattice. Since 5 is a unit at two and at three, Λ splits orthogonally as $\mathbf{Z}v \perp N$ over $\mathbf{Z}_2$ and over $\mathbf{Z}_3$, so the whole discriminant group of Λ is carried by N and the kernel of Proposition 2.4 lies in $N \otimes M$. What separates the two summands is five-adic: $[\Lambda : \mathbf{Z}v + N] = 5$, and tensoring with the rank-two lattice M squares that to $[\Lambda \otimes M : (\mathbf{Z}v \otimes M) \oplus (N \otimes M)] = 25$. Passing from $\Lambda \otimes M$ to L enlarges the N -summand alone, by the previous sentence, so this index is also the index in L used below.

Write $L_1 = L \cap (\mathbf{Q}v \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}})$ and $L_4 = L \cap (N_{\mathbf{Q}} \otimes M_{\mathbf{Q}})$ for the two primitive summands, so that A_1 and the intrinsic four-dimensional factor of the second case have these as their integral homology. Then $L_1 = \mathbf{Z}v \otimes M$ carries 5 times a unimodular alternating form, so $\det L_1 = 25$; since L is unimodular and $[L : L_1 \oplus L_4] = 25$, we get $\det L_1 \cdot \det L_4 = 25^2$ and hence $\det L_4 = 25$. A rank-eight alternating lattice of determinant 25 has elementary divisors 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 5, 5, that is polarization type (1, 1, 1, 5), so L_4 is not unimodular and the intrinsic four-dimensional factor is not principally polarized. Its discriminant group is glued to that of L_1 , which is $M/5M = E[5]$; the discriminant pairing is alternating, so every subgroup of order five is isotropic, and each of the six gives a unimodular overlattice of L_4 . The second case of the proposition therefore admits at most six principally polarized abelian fourfolds, each five-isogenous to the intrinsic factor, one for each order-five subgroup of $E[5]$, and exactly six unless two of the overlattices are isomorphic as polarized varieties. The stabilizer D_5 of the axis acts trivially on disc L_4 , since it acts trivially on M and the gluing is equivariant, so it fixes each of the six and the A_5 -structure selects none of them. The factors the proof of the proposition constructs are obtained from these by a further shrink of odd index, so they are odd-degree isogenous to them rather than equal to them; a genus-four question about the second case is a question about this finite list.

3 Integral divisor products and the primitive minimal class

Let (A, Θ) be a principally polarized abelian variety of dimension g . Put

$$P_A^k = \text{im}(\text{Sym}^k \text{NS}(A) \longrightarrow H^{2k}(A, \mathbf{Z})), \quad \gamma_A = \frac{\Theta^{g-1}}{(g-1)!}.$$

The class $D^k/k!$ of a divisor on an abelian variety is integral. The question here is whether these divided powers already belong to the smaller lattice P_A^k generated by ordinary products of integral divisors.

For quotients of elliptic powers, this question is controlled by the valuation pattern of the descended coefficient forms. The main local result of this section says that finite-étale graph

slopes force all divided powers of the prescribed graph divisor lattice into ordinary products, in every degree. The proof has two steps: the graph equations produce a symmetric matrix-of-ideals lattice, and a midpoint inequality makes that lattice rank-one generated. Rank-one coefficient divisors have square zero, so their divided powers expand without factorials. The six-axis application supplies the primitive minimal class needed below.

3.1 A local graph theorem

Work over a complete unramified discrete valuation ring O , with uniformizer p . Fix an elliptic curve E , an isogeny $q : E^n \rightarrow Y$ to a principally polarized abelian variety, and extend the p -adic coefficient lattices to O . A symmetric matrix $A \in \text{Sym}_n(O)$ denotes the standard coefficient divisor D_A on E^n , generated by coordinate and Poincare divisors. Define the prescribed graph-divisor lattice and its ordinary product image by

$$N_{\text{gr}}(q, O) = \{D \in \text{NS}(Y) \otimes O : q^*D = D_A \text{ for some } A \in \text{Sym}_n(O)\},$$

$$P_{\text{gr}}^k = \text{im}\left(\text{Sym}^k N_{\text{gr}}(q, O) \longrightarrow H^{2k}(Y, \mathbf{Z}_p) \otimes O\right).$$

Because q^* is injective on torsion-free cohomology, we identify $N_{\text{gr}}(q, O)$ with the symmetric matrices whose coefficient divisors descend through q . This is the prescribed lattice even when E has complex multiplication; no extra CM divisor is included.

Suppose the pullback coefficient polarization on the elliptic-power source is

$$G = PB, \quad P = \bigoplus_a p^a I_{M_a}, \quad B = \frac{1}{a} B_a,$$

where each B_a is unimodular. A *marked finite-étale graph presentation* consists of a symplectic ruling of the primary polarization kernel in which $\ker q$ is the graph of an endomorphism T , with the following properties: T preserves the depth summands M_a ,

$$T^t B^{-1} = B^{-1} T \quad \text{or, equivalently,} \quad B T^t = T B, \quad (3.1)$$

and the algebra generated by T modulo p^a is finite étale on every positive-depth summand. Thus adjointness is taken for the dual coefficient form B^{-1} . No étaleness is required on M_0 .

After a finite unramified extension splitting these étale algebras, the positive-depth summands decompose orthogonally into blocks

$$L_i = L_{a_i, \lambda_i}, \quad T_i = t_i I + p^{a_i} S_i, \quad (3.2)$$

with S_i integral. Indeed, completeness lifts the primitive idempotents of each split finite-étale quotient to idempotents in the algebra generated by T . They are polynomials in T , so (3.1) makes them self-adjoint for B^{-1} . Their images are therefore mutually orthogonal for B^{-1} , and hence for B ; on each image, T is scalar modulo the corresponding power p^{a_i} . We keep the unit part as one block. Write $\delta_{ij} = v_p(t_j - t_i)$, with $v_p(0) = \infty$, for two positive-depth blocks.

Lemma 3.1 (The graph coefficient lattice). *In the split basis, the coefficient lattice of descended graph divisors is the symmetric matrix-of-ideals lattice whose diagonal block i has depth p^{a_i} and whose (i, j) -block has depth*

$$e_{ij} = \max\{a_i, a_j, a_i + a_j - \delta_{ij}\}. \quad (3.3)$$

For the unit block and a positive-depth block j , one has $e_{0j} = a_j$. In particular,

$$e_{ij} \geq \max(a_i, a_j) \geq \left\lceil \frac{a_i + a_j}{2} \right\rceil. \quad (3.4)$$

Proof. Choose the symplectic basis determined by the marked ruling and the depth decomposition. Adjoining the graph generators to the source homology lattice gives the quotient lattice, and in these coordinates the change-of-lattice matrix is

$$C = \begin{pmatrix} P^{-1} & P^{-1}T \\ 0 & I \end{pmatrix}.$$

A coefficient alternating form descends precisely when its matrix transported by C is integral. For a symmetric source coefficient A , direct multiplication gives

$$C \begin{pmatrix} 0 & A \\ -A & 0 \end{pmatrix} C^t = \begin{pmatrix} P^{-1}(AT^t - TA)P^{-1} & P^{-1}A \\ -AP^{-1} & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (3.5)$$

Thus descent is equivalent to the integrality of the three displayed nonzero blocks. Here $A = A^t$ is a symmetric coefficient bilinear form in this normalization. On two positive-depth blocks $L_i \times L_j$, the two off-diagonal blocks first force A_{ij} to have depth $\max(a_i, a_j)$. Substituting $T_i = t_i I + p^{a_i} S_i$ into the upper-left block leaves the additional condition

$$p^{-a_i - a_j}(t_j - t_i)A_{ij} \in M_{r_i \times r_j}(O);$$

the terms containing S_i, S_j are already integral. Intersecting the two conditions gives (3.3). Changing a scalar lift cannot change its maximum. Pairing the unsplit unit block with L_j gives $e_{0j} = a_j$ directly from (3.5), and (3.4) follows. $\square$

The inequality (3.4) is the valuation shadow of the tropical positive semidefinite cone studied by Yu [37]. We need the following signed integral lift of that inequality; in particular, no division by two is permitted.

Lemma 3.2 (Rank-one generation over a DVR). *Let L be a symmetric matrix-of-ideals lattice over O , with diagonal depths p^{a_i} and cross depths $p^{e_{ij}}$. Then L is generated by its rank-one forms if and only if*

$$2e_{ij} \geq a_i + a_j \quad (i \neq j).$$

Proof. If $cvv^t \in L$, the two diagonal conditions imply

$$v_p(cv_i v_j) \geq \left\lceil \frac{a_i + a_j}{2} \right\rceil.$$

Hence rank-one forms cannot generate a shallower cross ideal.

Conversely, fix a generator $p^e(uv^t + vu^t)$ of a cross block. Choose $x \geq a_i$ with $y = 2e - x \geq a_j$. The integers x, y have the same parity. If $t = \min(x, y)$, write $x = t + 2r$ and $y = t + 2s$. Then

$$p^t(p^r u + p^s v)(p^r u + p^s v)^t - p^x u u^t - p^y v v^t = p^e(uv^t + vu^t).$$

All three rank-one terms lie in L . Together with the diagonal rank-one forms, these identities generate L , without division by two. $\square$

Theorem 3.3 (All-degree graph saturation). *For a marked finite-étale graph presentation, every divided power of a class in its prescribed graph divisor lattice is an ordinary integral divisor product. Equivalently, after localization at p , the divided-power envelope of that lattice and its ordinary product image agree in every degree.*

Proof. After the unramified splitting extension, Lemmas 3.1 and 3.2 express every class in the extended graph divisor lattice as a finite sum $D = R_1 + \cdots + R_m$ of rank-one coefficient classes. These are classes in the coefficient extension of the original lattice, not newly descended line bundles. On the elliptic-power source the alternating form of each R_i has rank two, hence $R_i^2 = 0$. Pullback by the isogeny is injective on torsion-free cohomology, so the same identity holds on the quotient. Therefore

$$\frac{D^k}{k!} = \sum_{1 \leq i_1 < \cdots < i_k \leq m} R_{i_1} \cdots R_{i_k}, \quad (3.6)$$

an O' -linear combination of ordinary products over the splitting ring O' . More precisely,

$$P_{\text{gr}}^k \otimes_O O' = \text{im} \left(\text{Sym}^k(N_{\text{gr}} \otimes_O O') \longrightarrow H^{2k} \otimes_O O' \right).$$

Faithful flatness descends the quotient of these finite lattices, and hence descends (3.6) to O , and therefore to $\mathbf{Z}_p$ in the six-axis application. $\square$

The theorem concerns the divisor lattice selected by the marked elliptic-power presentation. If E has no complex multiplication, this is the full Neron–Severi lattice. At a CM fibre extra divisor classes need not satisfy the graph hypotheses. The statement is cohomological: it neither constructs Chow divided powers nor asserts that every integral Hodge class is a divisor product.

For comparison with the classical rational theory, Milne proves that the Lefschetz classes are the rational algebra generated by divisors [27, Theorem 3.2]. Divided powers in Chow and integral Fourier transforms are studied in [28, 3]. The local result above instead keeps the weighted integral graph lattice and the ordinary, rather than divided, product image.

3.2 The six-axis packet

We now apply the graph theorem to the polarization computed in Section 2.

We use the following elementary depth-one lifting observation. Let U be a unimodular O -lattice with symmetric Gram matrix B . Every endomorphism $\bar{T}$ of U/pU that is self-adjoint for $\bar{B}^{-1}$ has a lift $T \in \text{End}_O(U)$ satisfying

$$T^t B^{-1} = B^{-1} T. \quad (3.7)$$

The construction may be performed separately on orthogonal depth summands. Choose any lift T_0 . Its adjointness defect has the form

$$T_0^t B^{-1} - B^{-1} T_0 = pD,$$

where D is skew-symmetric with zero diagonal. Choose an integral matrix C with $C^t - C = -D$, for example by assigning its entries strictly above and below the diagonal. Then $T = T_0 + pBC$ reduces to $\bar{T}$, and

$$T^t B^{-1} - B^{-1} T = p(D + C^t - C) = 0.$$

No division by two is used. Applying the construction blockwise preserves the depth decomposition.

Lemma 3.4 (Local chart for the six-axis quotient). *Let $G = 6I_5 - J_5$. At each prime $p \mid 6$, the coefficient lattice has an orthogonal decomposition*

$$(\mathbf{Z}_p^5, G) \simeq U_0 \perp pU_1,$$

where U_0 has rank one and U_1 rank four, both unimodular. The principal quotient is trivial on U_0 . On U_1/pU_1 , its graph slope has minimal polynomial $t^2 + t + 1$ at $p = 2$; at $p = 3$ it is a scalar, hence a one-point finite-étale block, after choosing a complementary symplectic ruling if the selected half is vertical. In both cases the slope has a depth-preserving integral lift that is self-adjoint for the dual coefficient form, so these data give a marked finite-étale graph presentation.

Proof. Let $e_1, \dots, e_5$ be the standard basis. Since $\langle e_1, e_1 \rangle = 5$ and $\langle e_1, e_j \rangle = -1$, the vectors

$$v_j = e_j + \frac{1}{5}e_1 \quad (2 \leq j \leq 5)$$

span the orthogonal complement of e_1 over $\mathbf{Z}_p$. Its Gram matrix is $\frac{6}{5}(5I_4 - J_4)$, and $\det(5I_4 - J_4) = 5^3$. This gives the asserted unit line and depth-one block at two and three. The unit line contributes nothing to the p -primary discriminant group, so the p -primary isogeny kernel is supported entirely on U_1/pU_1 .

At two, Proposition 2.4 applies to every smooth fibre and identifies its geometric kernel with one of the two exotic graphs. Isotropy says that either slope is self-adjoint for the reduced dual form. It is a root in $\mathbf{F}_4$ of $t^2 + t + 1$, so its generated algebra is finite étale. The preceding lifting argument supplies the required integral self-adjoint lift on U_1 . At three, the same proposition says that every A_5 -stable half is a scalar graph because the coefficient heart is simple with commutant $\mathbf{F}_3$ by Lemma 2.1. More precisely, the four halves form $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_3)$. If the selected member is vertical, choose any other member as the complementary vertical ruling; the selected half then becomes the graph of a scalar (including zero). This change is only in the symplectic ruling of the primary kernel. The chosen symplectic basis of its two-dimensional multiplicity space lifts from $\mathbf{F}_3$ to $\mathbf{Z}_3$: equivalently, reduction $\mathrm{Sp}_2(\mathbf{Z}_3) \rightarrow \mathrm{Sp}_2(\mathbf{F}_3)$ is surjective. Thus it lifts to an integral change of ruling preserving the alternating form; the depth-one coefficient block and its scale $P = 3I$ are unchanged. The algebra generated by the resulting scalar is $\mathbf{F}_3$, hence is a one-point finite-étale block, and the same lifting argument applies. Extend each lift by a scalar on U_0 . No global choice of either slope is needed. $\square$

Theorem 3.5 (Divided powers for the six-axis family). *For every smooth member X_b of the nonstandard A_5 -cubic pencil, the prescribed six-axis graph divisor lattice on J_b has all its integral divided powers in the ordinary divisor-product image. In particular,*

$$\frac{\Theta_b^4}{4!} \in P_{J_b}^4. \quad (3.8)$$

Proof. Only the primes two and three occur in the Smith form $(1, 6, 6, 6, 6)$. Lemma 3.4 verifies the hypotheses of Theorem 3.3 at both primes. At every other prime the isogeny identifies the integral source and target lattices; equivalently the marked presentation has only its unit block $P = I$, so Theorem 3.3 applies trivially (or directly by Lemma 3.2). Thus the image of each desired divided power in the finitely generated quotient $H^{2k}(J_b, \mathbf{Z})/P_{J_b}^k$ vanishes after tensoring with $\mathbf{Z}_p$ for every prime p , and hence vanishes integrally: a finitely generated abelian group splits as a free part and a finite part, and both are detected by these completions. Finally, Lemma 2.3 gives $f_b^* \Theta_b = \lambda_{\mathcal{A}_b}$. The principal polarization is therefore one of the descended graph divisors defining the prescribed lattice, yielding (3.8). Extra Neron–Severi classes at a special fibre can only enlarge the ordinary product image needed for this last assertion. $\square$

Voisin identifies the primitive minimal class as the exact obstruction needed for cubic threefolds.

Corollary 3.6 (Universal CH_0 -triviality). *Every smooth member of the nonstandard A_5 -cubic pencil is universally CH_0 -trivial.*

Proof. By Theorem 3.5, the primitive minimal class of the intermediate Jacobian is algebraic. Voisin's Corollary 4.4 [35] says that, for a smooth complex cubic threefold, this is equivalent to universal CH_0 -triviality. $\square$

Two comparisons place the pencil against the parts of the algebraic locus that were known before. Write M_{H_1} for the coarse-moduli image of the pencil, as in Hartlieb's notation. Both comparisons run through one classical criterion.

Lemma 3.7 (Eckardt criterion). *Let $X = \{F = 0\} \subset \mathbf{P}^4$ be a smooth cubic threefold and let $p \in X$. The tangent hyperplane section $T_p X \cap X$ is a cone with vertex p – that is, p is an Eckardt point of X – if and only if the Hessian matrix of F at p has rank at most two. Every smooth cubic threefold in either of two classes carries an Eckardt point: those whose defining form is a sum of cubic forms in pairwise disjoint nonempty groups of at most three variables, and the members of the family of [38, Theorem 3.3].*

Proof. Choose coordinates with $p = [1 : 0 : 0 : 0 : 0]$ and write $F = x_0^2 L + x_0 Q + C$ with L, Q and C in $x_1, \dots, x_4$. Smoothness at p makes L nonzero, the tangent hyperplane is $\{L = 0\}$, and the section is a cone with vertex p exactly when Q vanishes on $\{L = 0\}$, that is when $Q \in (L)$. The Hessian of F at p is the matrix of the quadric $4x_0 L + 2Q$. If $Q = LR$ for a linear form R , that quadric is $L(4x_0 + 2R)$, of rank at most two. Conversely a quadric of rank at most two is a product of two linear forms; the coefficient of x_0^2 vanishes, so at most one factor involves x_0 , and if neither did then L would vanish. Comparing the terms linear in x_0 shows that the other factor is proportional to L , so $Q \in (L)$.

Let $F = \sum_j F_j$ be separated, with the j -th form in $n_j \leq 3$ variables and $\sum_j n_j = 5$. Either some $n_j = 2$, or the parts are 3, 1, 1 or 1, 1, 1, 1, 1 and at least two of them are singletons. In the first case the binary cubic F_j has a nonzero root, and the corresponding point of $\mathbf{P}^4$, supported on those two variables, lies on X . In the second, let cx^3 and $c'y^3$ be two singleton summands, with c and c' nonzero because X is smooth, and take the point supported on x and y with coordinates satisfying $ca^3 + c'b^3 = 0$. In both cases every diagonal block of the Hessian belonging to another part vanishes there, since a cubic form has vanishing Hessian at the origin, so the rank is at most two.

For the family of [38, Theorem 3.3] work in their coordinates $x_1, \dots, x_5$ and take p to be the point where $x_1 = 1$ and the other four vanish. It lies on the threefold; every partial derivative of their form vanishes at p except the one in x_3 , whose value is their nonzero coefficient t_1 , so the tangent hyperplane is $\{x_3 = 0\}$; and the restriction of their form to that hyperplane does not involve x_1 , so the section is a cone with vertex p . $\square$

The general member of the pencil carries no such point, and the members that do are pinned down by a classification rather than by a search. The mechanism is that an Eckardt point is the same object as a reflection preserving the defining form. A cubic threefold with an irreducibly acting automorphism group and an Eckardt point therefore has its form invariant under an irreducible complex reflection group of rank five, and the invariant degrees of those groups leave two possibilities, of which one is singular.

Lemma 3.8 (Eckardt points are reflection centres). *Let $X = \{F = 0\} \subset \mathbf{P}^4$ be a smooth cubic threefold. Call $r \in \mathrm{GL}_5(\mathbf{C})$ a reflection if it has order two and fixes a hyperplane pointwise, and call the line on which it acts by -1 its centre. Sending r to its centre is a bijection from the set of reflections with $F \circ r = F$ onto the set of Eckardt points of X .*

Proof. Let r be a reflection with $F \circ r = F$, and choose coordinates with centre $p = [1 : 0 : 0 : 0 : 0]$ and $r : x_0 \mapsto -x_0$. Invariance kills the odd powers of x_0 , so $F = x_0^2 L + C$ with L and C in $x_1, \dots, x_4$. Then $F(p) = 0$, so $p \in X$; the Hessian of F at p carries the coefficients of L in its first row and column and vanishes elsewhere, so it has rank at most two; and $L \neq 0$, since otherwise every first partial derivative of F would vanish at p . By Lemma 3.7, p is an Eckardt point.

The map is injective. A second reflection r' with $F \circ r' = F$ and the same centre has mirror $\{x_0 = \ell\}$ for a linear form ℓ in $x_1, \dots, x_4$. In the coordinate $u = x_0 - \ell$ the form reads $F = u^2 L + 2u\ell L + (\ell^2 L + C)$, and invariance under $u \mapsto -u$ forces $\ell L = 0$, hence $\ell = 0$ and $r' = r$.

The map is surjective. Let p be an Eckardt point, and in coordinates with $p = [1 : 0 : 0 : 0 : 0]$ write $F = x_0^2 L + x_0 Q + C$ with L, Q, C in $x_1, \dots, x_4$; by the proof of Lemma 3.7, $L \neq 0$ and $Q = LR$ for a linear form R . Substituting $x_0 - R/2$ for x_0 fixes p and turns F into $x_0^2 L + (C - LR^2/4)$, so the reflection $x_0 \mapsto -x_0$ fixes F and has centre p . $\square$

Proposition 3.9 (Irreducible symmetry with an Eckardt point). *Let $X = \{F = 0\} \subset \mathbf{P}^4$ be a smooth cubic threefold whose automorphism group acts irreducibly on $\mathbf{C}^5$. If X carries an Eckardt point, then X is projectively equivalent to the Fermat cubic threefold and carries exactly thirty Eckardt points.*

Proof. Let $R \subset \mathrm{GL}_5(\mathbf{C})$ be generated by the reflections r with $F \circ r = F$; by Lemma 3.8 there is at least one. Every generator fixes F , so F is an R -invariant of degree three, and every reflection of R again fixes F and so belongs to that generating set. The group is finite: its image in $\mathrm{PGL}_5(\mathbf{C})$ lies in the finite group $\mathrm{Aut}(X)$, and each generator has determinant -1 , so a scalar $c \in R$ satisfies $c^5 = \pm 1$.

The action of R is irreducible. Let $\tilde{G}$ be the group of matrices carrying F to a scalar multiple of itself. Conjugating a reflection that fixes F by an element of $\tilde{G}$ gives another, so $\tilde{G}$ normalizes R and permutes the isotypic components of $\mathbf{C}^5$ under R . The sum over an orbit of components is $\tilde{G}$ -invariant, and $\tilde{G}$ surjects onto $\mathrm{Aut}(X)$, so the permutation is transitive and the number of components divides five. Five components would make R diagonal in the resulting basis, its reflections the sign changes in a single coordinate, and transitivity would put all five of those in R ; a cubic form invariant under all five is even in each variable, hence zero. So there is one isotypic component. Its irreducible constituent is not one-dimensional, since then R would act by scalars and contain no reflection. Hence $\mathbf{C}^5$ is irreducible under R , which is therefore an irreducible complex reflection group of rank five.

Three is one of its degrees. The invariants of R form a polynomial ring on five homogeneous generators, each of degree at least two because an irreducible reflection group fixes no linear form. A nonzero invariant of degree three is therefore a scalar multiple of a generator of degree three.

Two groups have one. The irreducible complex reflection groups of rank five are $G(1, 1, 6)$, the groups $G(m, p, 5)$ with $m \geq 2$ and $p \mid m$, and G_{33} ; their degrees are 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, then $m, 2m, 3m, 4m, 5m/p$, and 4, 6, 10, 12, 18 [34]. Three occurs only for $G(1, 1, 6)$ and for $m = 3$, since $5m/p = 3$ would need $p > m$; and in each case it occurs once, so F is that generator up to scalar. For $G(1, 1, 6)$, the symmetric group on six letters acting on the sum-zero subspace of $\mathbf{C}^6$, the generator is the third elementary symmetric function and its zero locus is the Segre cubic threefold, which has ten nodes; that contradicts smoothness. For $G(3, p, 5)$, acting by monomial matrices whose nonzero entries are cube roots of unity, the generator is $y_1^3 + \dots + y_5^3$. So X is the Fermat cubic threefold in those coordinates.

It remains to count. R is generated by reflections of order two, and the order-two reflections of $G(3, 1, 5)$ generate its subgroup $G(3, 3, 5)$, so $R = G(3, 3, 5)$, whose degrees

are 3, 6, 9, 12, 5. The Eckardt points of X correspond to the reflections of R by Lemma 3.8 and the first paragraph, and an irreducible reflection group has $\sum_i (d_i - 1)$ reflections, here $2 + 5 + 8 + 11 + 4 = 30$. $\square$

Remark 3.10. The argument does not use the dimension until the last two steps, and running it for a smooth cubic hypersurface in $\mathbf{P}^N$ with $N \geq 3$ leaves the Fermat cubic together with the diagonal cubic $\{e_1 = e_3 = 0\}$, the invariant of the symmetric group on $N + 2$ letters acting on the sum-zero subspace of $\mathbf{C}^{N+2}$. The diagonal cubic is singular exactly when N is even: a singular point forces all x_i^2 equal, hence coordinates $\pm t$ in equal numbers. For $N = 3$ both survive, as the Fermat and Clebsch cubic surfaces, with $\sum_i (d_i - 1)$ equal to eighteen and ten reflections; those are their classical Eckardt counts. For $N = 4$ the diagonal cubic is the Segre cubic threefold and only the Fermat member survives, which is the case used above. The restriction $N \geq 3$ is needed: for plane cubics the group $G(3, 3, 3)$ has degree three twice, its invariants of that degree are the Hesse pencil, and every smooth plane cubic accordingly has inflection points.

Proposition 3.11 (The Eckardt locus of the pencil). *Exactly two members of the pencil are smooth cubic threefolds carrying an Eckardt point. They are interchanged by the normalizer of A_5 in $\mathrm{PGL}(W_5)$, each carries exactly thirty Eckardt points, and both are projectively equivalent over $\mathbf{C}$ to the Fermat cubic threefold, so they represent a single point of the coarse-moduli image M_{H_1} . Every other point of M_{H_1} is represented only by smooth cubic threefolds with no Eckardt point; in particular no other point is represented by a cubic projectively equivalent to a member of the family of [38, Theorem 3.3].*

Proof. Every member of the pencil is invariant under A_5 acting irreducibly on W_5 , so Proposition 3.9 applies to each member of B° : one carrying an Eckardt point is projectively equivalent to the Fermat cubic threefold and carries exactly thirty. Conversely the pencil contains the Fermat cubic threefold by Remark 1.6, and the Fermat form is separated, so Lemma 3.7 gives it an Eckardt point. The members carrying an Eckardt point are therefore exactly those projectively equivalent to the Fermat cubic threefold, and they represent the single point of M_{H_1} that it represents.

Counting them uses two facts about the ambient group. Write A for the image of A_5 in $\mathrm{PGL}(W_5)$ and N for its normalizer. The centralizer of A consists of scalars by Schur's lemma, so conjugation embeds N in $\mathrm{Aut}(A_5) \cong S_5$ with A as the inner automorphisms; the six-point model realizes the outer automorphism, since $\mathrm{PGL}(2, \mathbf{F}_5)$ permutes the six points of $\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{F}_5)$ and so acts on W_5 . Hence $N \cong S_5$ and $[N : A] = 2$. Second, any two subgroups of $\mathrm{PGL}_5(\mathbf{C})$ isomorphic to A_5 and acting irreducibly are conjugate: a five-dimensional projective representation of A_5 is linear, because the faithful representations of its double cover have dimensions two, four and six; A_5 has one irreducible character of degree five; and that character is fixed by $\mathrm{Aut}(A_5)$.

Write X_F for the Fermat cubic threefold. Sending a parameter b with X_b projectively equivalent to X_F to the $\mathrm{Aut}(X_F)$ conjugacy class of gAg^{-1} , for any g with $gX_b = X_F$, is well defined, since two such g differ by an element of $\mathrm{Aut}(X_F)$. It is surjective onto the classes of irreducibly acting copies of A_5 in $\mathrm{Aut}(X_F)$: given such a copy A' , conjugacy gives h with $hAh^{-1} = A'$, and $h^{-1}X_F$ is A -invariant, hence a member of the pencil mapping to the class of A' . Its fibres are the orbits of N : if $u \in \mathrm{Aut}(X_F)$ conjugates gAg^{-1} to $g'A(g')^{-1}$ then $n = (g')^{-1}ug$ normalizes A and carries X_b to $X_{b'}$, and conversely $n \in N$ with $nX_b = X_{b'}$ turns g into gn^{-1} .

Now $\mathrm{Aut}(X_F)$ is $C_3^4 \rtimes S_5$, the diagonal cube roots of unity modulo scalars extended by the coordinate permutations [36, Example 3.1]. A subgroup isomorphic to A_5 meets C_3^4 in one of its own normal abelian subgroups, hence trivially, so it is a complement to

C_3^4 over the alternating subgroup, and such complements are classified up to C_3^4 -conjugacy by $H^1(A_5, C_3^4)$. As a module, C_3^4 is the sum-zero submodule of $\mathbf{F}_3^5$, which splits off the diagonal line because five is invertible modulo three; A_5 has no homomorphism to $\mathbf{F}_3$; and $\mathbf{F}_3^5$ is induced from the trivial module of a point stabilizer A_4 . So Shapiro's lemma gives

$$H^1(A_5, C_3^4) = H^1(A_5, \mathbf{F}_3^5) = H^1(A_4, \mathbf{F}_3) = \text{Hom}(A_4, \mathbf{F}_3) \cong \mathbf{F}_3.$$

The trivial class is the group of coordinate permutations, which acts reducibly. An element of $\text{Aut}(X_F)$ lying over a transposition acts on $H^1(A_5, C_3^4)$ by inversion, because conjugation by a transposition inverts the cyclic quotient of A_4 , so the two remaining classes are fused. Exactly one class of irreducibly acting copies of A_5 survives, and the parameters with X_b projectively equivalent to X_F form a single N -orbit.

That orbit has two elements. If N fixed one of them, then N , which is isomorphic to S_5 and acts irreducibly, would sit inside $\text{Aut}(X_F)$; the same argument would make it a complement to C_3^4 , and $H^1(S_5, C_3^4) = H^1(S_4, \mathbf{F}_3) = 0$ leaves only the group of coordinate permutations, which acts reducibly. So N permutes the two members without fixing either, and $[N : A] = 2$ makes them a single N -orbit of size two.

Finally every member of the family of [38, Theorem 3.3] carries an Eckardt point, again by Lemma 3.7, and carrying one is invariant under projective equivalence, which gives the last claim. $\square$

The two members can be named in coordinates, and the pencil's singular members with them. Nothing above or below depends on this.

Lemma 3.12 (The two loci in the six-point model). *Write the pencil as $p_3 + bT_1$ in the six-point model of §2, in the chart where the coefficient of p_3 is one. The two members of Proposition 3.11 are the roots of $b^2 + 3b + 9$, that is $b = 3\omega$ for a primitive cube root of unity ω . The singular members are the roots of $b(b+6)(b^2 - 3b - 9)(7b^2 + 3b + 9)$, the first of them the Segre cubic threefold. The remaining pencil point, the cubic T_1 , is smooth with no Eckardt point.*

Proof. By Lemma 3.7 a point p of a smooth X_b is an Eckardt point exactly when the Hessian of F_b at p has rank at most two, so the parameters sought are those for which the ideal generated by F_b and the three-by-three minors of its Hessian has a zero away from the origin. Saturating that ideal by the irrelevant ideal and eliminating the five coordinates gives $b(b^2 + 3b + 9)$; the same for the Jacobian ideal alone gives $b(b+6)(b^2 - 3b - 9)(7b^2 + 3b + 9)$, whose zero set is the reduced locus of singular parameters, that is the radical of the pencil's discriminant rather than the discriminant itself. Both are Gröbner eliminations over $\mathbf{Q}$, trusted as executions of a computer algebra system rather than certificate-checked; the registered evidence bundle records the replay commands and two independent cross-checks. They are carried out in the chart above, and the remaining pencil point is treated directly there.

Elimination computes the ideal of the Zariski closure of the projection, so this identifies the set of parameters sought only up to closure. Here the two agree: the set is constructible by Chevalley's theorem, its closure is finite, and a constructible subset of the affine line with finite closure is itself finite, hence closed.

The factor b common to the two eliminated ideals is the Segre cubic threefold, the second branch of Proposition 3.9, which is singular, so it is not a member of B° and Lemma 3.7 does not apply to it. The roots of $b^2 + 3b + 9$ are prime to the second polynomial, so those two members are smooth and carry an Eckardt point; Proposition 3.11 shows that these are the only such members. $\square$

Proposition 3.13 (The separated-variable intersection). *Exactly one point of M_{H_1} is represented by a smooth cubic threefold that is projectively equivalent to a cubic whose defining form is a sum of cubic forms in pairwise disjoint nonempty groups of at most three variables, namely the Fermat point of Proposition 3.11. Consequently, every other point of M_{H_1} is represented by universally CH_0 -trivial cubic threefolds by Corollary 3.6, none of which is covered by the separated-variable criterion of Colliot-Thélène [14].*

Proof. By Lemma 3.7 a smooth cubic threefold of separated-variable type carries an Eckardt point, and carrying one is invariant under projective equivalence, so the points of M_{H_1} represented by such cubics are among those of Proposition 3.11, which is the Fermat point alone. That point is represented by such a cubic: the Fermat form $x_1^3 + \cdots + x_5^3$ is a sum of cubic forms in five disjoint groups of one variable each. Hence the two loci coincide. Every remaining point is represented by a universally CH_0 -trivial cubic threefold by Corollary 3.6, and by no cubic projectively equivalent to a separated-variable form, so the criterion of [14] does not apply to it. $\square$

The order-three signatures give finiteness, though not the exact locus, by an independent route. Fix a primitive cube root of unity ζ_3 . The signature of an order-three automorphism of a smooth cubic threefold is the tuple of exponents of ζ_3 in a diagonalization of a linear lift of order three; it is well defined up to permutation of the entries, replacement of ζ_3 by ζ_3^2 , and multiplication of the lift by a cube root of unity [16, Definition 2.1]. In a separated-variable form, as in Proposition 3.13, the groups of variables are disjoint, nonempty and of size at most three, and they cover all five variables, since a cubic threefold whose form omits a variable is singular at the corresponding coordinate point; as five is not a multiple of three, at least one group has size one or two. Multiplying the variables of such a group by ζ_3 fixes the form, so such a cubic admits an order-three automorphism of signature $(0, 0, 0, 0, 1)$ or $(0, 0, 0, 1, 1)$. González-Aguilera–Liendo identify these two signatures as their families T_3^1 and T_3^2 [16, Theorem 2.5]. The union of the two families therefore contains every point of M_{H_1} represented by a cubic projectively equivalent to a separated-variable form. Each family is the image in moduli of $U^G/N_{\mathrm{GL}_5(\mathbf{C})}(G)$, for U^G the locus of smooth cubics fixed by the relevant group G and $N_{\mathrm{GL}_5(\mathbf{C})}(G)$ its normalizer, under a finite morphism, hence closed [20, Lemmas 2.6–2.7]. The Klein cubic lies in the pencil [20, Lemmas 2.6–2.7 and Proposition 5.7], its automorphism group $\mathrm{PSL}(2, \mathbf{F}_{11})$ has a single conjugacy class of elements of order three, and its signature is $(0, 0, 1, 1, 2)$ [16, Proposition 2.6]. The multiplicities of the eigenvalues $1, \zeta_3, \zeta_3^2$ are $(2, 2, 1)$ for that signature and $(4, 1, 0)$ and $(3, 2, 0)$ for the two signatures above. Permuting the entries leaves these triples unchanged, multiplying the lift by a cube root of unity permutes them cyclically, and replacing ζ_3 by ζ_3^2 transposes the last two, so the three moves compare the triples only as multisets; as $\{1, 2, 2\}$, $\{0, 1, 4\}$ and $\{0, 2, 3\}$ are distinct, the Klein cubic lies in neither family. Some $b \in B^\circ$ has X_b projectively equivalent to the Klein cubic, by the membership just recorded, and B° is a nonempty open subset of a $\mathbf{P}^1$, hence an irreducible curve. The preimage in B° of each of the two loci under the map to moduli is closed and omits that b , so it is a proper closed subset of B° and therefore finite. Since M_{H_1} is the image of B° , each locus meets M_{H_1} in a finite set. This is a second proof of finiteness, from prime-order signatures rather than from reflections, and it does not identify the finite set; that identification is Propositions 3.11 and 3.13.

Every moduli point of the pencil but the Fermat point escapes the separated-variable mechanism of [14] by Proposition 3.13 and the explicit family of [38] by Proposition 3.11, and Proposition 2.5 closes the product route into Voisin’s components. None of them asserts that the A_5 -curve is disjoint from every known part of Voisin’s algebraic-minimal-class locus; the two questions left open there are recorded after Proposition 2.5.

The argument is fibrewise. It constructs neither a horizontal minimal cycle over the pencil nor a relative decomposition of the diagonal. Neither is needed for Corollary 3.6.

4 Categorical QDM markers and one stabilization

We prove the unconditional theorem by applying the quantum D -module decomposition formulas directly. The common argument is stated first for an arbitrary additive marker. The rest of the section constructs the smallest marker needed for a cubic threefold and verifies its center nullity. The framed invariant of Section 5 will apply the same ledger theorem to a block type carrying additional framing data.

4.1 The one-blowup model

Let Y be smooth and projective. Pass to numerical Novikov variables, set the odd bulk variables to zero, and restrict the carrier of the quantum connection to $H^{\text{ev}}(Y)$. The last restriction is essential: even bulk alone still leaves the odd cohomology in the fibre. Let K_Y be the generic coefficient field of this even QDM and fix an algebraic closure $\overline{K}_Y$. All spectral blocks below are formed only after base change to $\overline{K}_Y$. Thus later scalar extensions do not split a primary factor that was previously counted as one block.

Let U be multiplication by the Euler field on the even carrier. Its generalized eigenspaces over $\overline{K}_Y$ are summands of the full formal connection, rather than merely summands of U :

Proposition 4.1 (Formal spectral connection splitting). *Suppose the leading operator of a finite free formal QDM has block-diagonal form $U_i = \lambda_i I + N_i$, where each N_i is nilpotent and $\lambda_i - \lambda_j$ is a unit for $i \neq j$. There is a unique gauge $G = I + O(z)$, regular in z and block off-diagonal in positive orders, which makes the z -connection block diagonal. In this gauge every bulk and Novikov direction is block diagonal as well. The horizontal pairing is block diagonal and nondegenerate on each factor.*

Proof. At order z^{n-1} , the (i, j) -entry of the gauge equation is a Sylvester equation

$$U_i X - X U_j = B_{n,ij}.$$

Its operator is $(\lambda_i - \lambda_j)I$ plus the nilpotent operator $X \mapsto N_i X - X N_j$, hence is invertible. Recursion gives the normalized gauge, and the same equation with zero right-hand side proves uniqueness.

Choose frames of the generalized-eigenspace subbundles after the splitting extension. If an off-diagonal block of a base-direction connection had a first nonzero Laurent coefficient Xz^m , the lowest off-diagonal coefficient of flatness would be $U_i X - X U_j = 0$, contrary to Sylvester invertibility. Thus every base direction preserves the same factors. Applied coefficientwise to pairing horizontality, the identical argument kills the off-diagonal pairing blocks. Nondegeneracy of the total pairing then makes every diagonal restriction nondegenerate. $\square$

We call these factors the *generic even QDM blocks* of Y . A basic block retains its connection, pairing, and centered Euler endomorphism, but not an absolute cohomological grading. A block type may require additional marked data. If it retains grading, morphisms may carry a recorded integral suspension and its marker fold must be invariant under that suspension. The atomic type below forgets absolute grading. Its morphisms preserve all retained data and are regular connection isomorphisms after scalar extension and formal change of bulk coordinates. In particular, their gauges use neither negative nor fractional powers of the connection variable z .

Fix a block type $\mathcal{T}$. Let $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}}$ be the regular-isomorphism groupoid of blocks of that type and put

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}} := \pi_0 \operatorname{Sym}^{\sqcup}(\Pi_{\mathcal{T}}),$$

the effective free commutative monoid on their isomorphism classes. Direct sum gives each Y a block ledger $\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{T}}(Y) \in \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}}$. A *marker fold* is a commutative-monoid homomorphism

$$w : \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}} \longrightarrow A, \quad I_w(Y) := w(\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{T}}(Y)),$$

where A is an effective commutative monoid. No group completion is made: it can destroy useful folds, including Boolean ones.

The two specializations use the following notation.

Symbol	Meaning
$\Pi_{\mathcal{T}}$	regular-isomorphism groupoid of typed QDM blocks
$\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}}$	$\pi_0 \operatorname{Sym}^{\sqcup}(\Pi_{\mathcal{T}})$, the effective block monoid
$\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{T}}(Y)$	block ledger of Y
$w : \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}} \rightarrow A$	additive marker fold into an effective monoid
ω_j	the j -th center occurrence in one blowup
$c_w(\omega_j)$	marker of that actual center occurrence

Table 1: Notation for the occurrence-indexed marker ledger.

Consider one blowup $\beta : \tilde{Y} = \operatorname{Bl}_Z Y \rightarrow Y$ along a smooth center of codimension $c \geq 2$. Iritani's comparison has one ambient summand and $c - 1$ center summands. We retain the occurrence data of each center summand: for the j -th, record

$$\omega_j = (\beta, Z, j, \varsigma_j, \chi_j), \quad 0 \leq j \leq c - 2,$$

where ς_j is Iritani's center reconstruction parameter and χ_j is the induced numerical Novikov specialization. Its correction is $c_w(\omega_j) := w(\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{T}}(Z; \omega_j))$. Equality is required only after applying w ; distinct block multisets may have the same marker.

Theorem 4.2 (Occurrence-indexed marker ledger). *Let $w : \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}} \rightarrow A$ be a marker fold unchanged by the allowed regular scalar extensions and formal coordinate changes. Suppose*

$$I_w(\mathbf{P}_Y(V)) = r I_w(Y), \quad \operatorname{rk} V = r, \quad (4.1)$$

$$I_w(\operatorname{Bl}_Z Y) = I_w(Y) + \sum_{j=0}^{c-2} c_w(\omega_j), \quad \operatorname{codim}_Y Z = c \geq 2. \quad (4.2)$$

If every actual smooth center occurrence of dimension at most $d - 2$ has zero correction, then I_w is a birational invariant of smooth projective d -folds.

Proof. Projective weak factorization writes a birational map of smooth projective d -folds as a zigzag of blowups and blowdowns along smooth centers of codimension at least two [1, Theorem 0.3.1]. By (4.2) and center nullity, the marker is unchanged at each step; the equalities therefore telescope. Disconnected centers are treated componentwise, while a divisor blowup is an isomorphism. $\square$

Equivalently, the marker descends on object sets:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \operatorname{Ob}(\operatorname{SmProj}_d) & \xrightarrow{I_w} & A \\ \downarrow & & \parallel \\ \operatorname{Ob}(\operatorname{SmProj}_d)/\sim_{\operatorname{bir}} & \xrightarrow{\bar{I}_w} & A. \end{array} \quad (4.3)$$

This square reformulates the proof; it is not an additional input. The standard Hodge-atom construction is a distinct specialization of this occurrence/groupoid/fold pattern; its exact type map and one-step carrier quotient are developed in [31].

4.2 The QDM operation providers

Four compatibility facts place the comparison theorems in the preceding framework. First, the intrinsic ample-adic completion and the Laurent neighborhood of a fibre or exceptional cusp need not map to one another. Iritani's display (1.1) supplies the required injective maps of graded completed coefficient rings [22, (1.1)]. For projective bundles the common source is $\mathbf{C}[z, q][[Q, \hat{\tau}]]$; on the blowup side one uses the corresponding graded source and, for center terms, the reduced image ring of Iritani's Remark 5.6. Embed the generic fields of these common images in a fixed algebraically closed overfield and form every primary block there. Base change after this splitting extension preserves the rank, nilpotent Jordan type, regular formal gauge, and formal exponent classes of each block; forming primary factors over a nonsplitting field before extension would not.

Second, the comparison is restricted to the even carrier, not merely to the even bulk base. The supermodule conventions and the pull-push and Fourier formulas in Iritani's Section 5.8 and Iritani-Koto's construction are parity-preserving. After the odd bulk variables are set to zero, the comparison and its inverse therefore restrict to mutually inverse maps on H^{ev} . This is the QDM on which the atomic ledger is formed.

Third, the comparisons are regular in z . Iritani's Theorem 5.18 and Iritani-Koto's Theorem 5.1 are respectively defined over rings of the form

$$\mathbf{C}[z]((q_{\text{exc}}^{-1/s}))[[Q, \hat{\tau}]], \quad \mathbf{C}[z]((q_{\text{fib}}^{-1/r'}))[[Q, \hat{\tau}]],$$

where Iritani-Koto take $r' = r$ when $r - 1$ is even and $r' = 2r$ when $r - 1$ is odd. Their inverses use no negative powers of z ; see also [24, Remark 5.3]. The maps are homogeneous but need not have degree zero: the projective-bundle map has degree $-(r-1)$, while Iritani's ambient and center components have degrees 0 and $-c$, respectively [24, Theorem 5.1(3)][22, Theorem 5.18(3)]. Because the atomic block type does not retain absolute grading, these shifts do not change its component. For a graded refinement they are recorded as integral suspensions, and the operation formula applies only to a fold invariant under those suspensions.

Fourth, Iritani's center map need not be injective [22, (5.15)]. After numerical reduction it has the form

$$Q_Z^d \longmapsto Q^{i_*d} q_{\text{exc}}^{-\rho_Z \cdot d / (c-1)}. \quad (4.4)$$

Choose divisors $D_1, \dots, D_\rho$ separating $N_1(Z)$ and retain the characters $\exp(\sum_k (D_k \cdot d) s_k)$. Every fibre of (4.4) is finite: an ample degree from Y bounds the lattice points in the corresponding slice of $\overline{NE}(Z)$. On a fibre of size n , a generic one-parameter restriction gives distinct exponentials. Their derivatives of orders $0, \dots, n-1$ form an invertible Vandermonde matrix, so the character-tagged map is injective. Remarks 2.3 and 5.6 of [22] show that divisor and Novikov variables occur in precisely these combinations. The reduced divisor-equation image ring with its retained character tags replaces the function-level symbol σ_j^* , which need not exist before reduction. Over this ring, each actual center term is a faithful scalar extension and formal reparametrization of the intrinsic generic numerical QDM of Z .

Proposition 4.3 (QDM operation ledgers). *Let a marker fold be preserved by the regular scalar extensions and formal coordinate changes described above, and by every recorded grading suspension if its block type retains grading. The projective-bundle and blowup QDM*

comparisons on the even carriers then supply (4.1) and (4.2); each center marker is evaluated at its actual occurrence ω_j .

Proof. For a rank- r bundle, Iritani–Koto’s Theorem 5.1 gives r copies of the base QDM after Laurent extension [24, Theorem 5.1]. Its invertible joint bulk Jacobian gives independent unit coordinates on the r target factors. In the j -th factor, changing its unit coordinate adds an independent scalar $u_j I$ to Euler multiplication. For two finite spectra, the resultant of their translated characteristic polynomials is a nonzero polynomial in $u_i - u_j$, with leading coefficient one. Hence the spectra of distinct factors are disjoint at the generic point: their primary blocks do not fuse when the direct sum is formed. Regularity, even-carrier restriction, the fixed splitting field, and suspension invariance therefore carry the marker blockwise across the comparison, and additivity gives (4.1). Tensoring the bundle by a line bundle, when needed for the global-generation convention, changes neither the projective bundle nor the intrinsic Novikov embedding [24, Remark 1.2 and Remark 5.2].

For a codimension- c blowup, Iritani’s Theorem 5.18 gives one ambient QDM and $c - 1$ center QDMs [22, Theorem 5.18]. Parts (4), (6), and (7) give the comparison asymptotics, the leading reconstruction parameters, and the invertible combined bulk Jacobian, respectively. The independent unit coordinates supplied by part (7) give the same nonzero resultant argument, so the ambient and occurrence-indexed center spectra are pairwise disjoint generically. Regularity, even-carrier restriction, the fixed splitting field, suspension invariance, and the faithful character argument for each center copy then give (4.2). Each comparison is evaluated over its own common coefficient spine; the proof never composes Laurent comparisons recursively. $\square$

The QDM comparison need not identify the two ledger elements before applying the fold. The relevant categorical operation is instead the additivity square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}} \times \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}} & \xrightarrow{+} & \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}} \\ w \times w \downarrow & & \downarrow w \\ A \times A & \xrightarrow{+} & A. \end{array} \quad (4.5)$$

At marker level, Proposition 4.3 supplies the resulting equalities in A ; its blowup statement also retains the occurrence metadata used by Theorem 4.2.

4.3 The rank-two formal-exponent marker

Let $\mathcal{T}_{\text{at}}$ be the block type on the H^{ev} -carrier retaining the connection, pairing, and centered Euler endomorphism, with no absolute grading, marked bulk section, or loop framing, and specialize to $A = \mathbf{N}$. Let E be a generic even block with centered connection

$$z \partial_z y = A(z)y, \quad A(z) = z^{-1}N + A_0 + zA_1 + z^2A_2 + \cdots. \quad (4.6)$$

Assume $\text{rk } E = 2$, $N \neq 0$, and $N^2 = 0$. Then $L = \text{im } N = \ker N$ is a line. Define

$$E^{\sharp} = \{s \in E : s \bmod z \in L\}. \quad (4.7)$$

Lemma 4.4 (The regular coefficient preserves the nilpotent line). *Horizontality of the Poincaré pairing implies $A_0 L \subset L$.*

Proof. Separated spectral factors are orthogonal for the horizontal Poincaré pairing: coefficientwise horizontality kills every off-diagonal block by an invertible Sylvester operator.

Hence the restriction to E is nondegenerate. Write it as $P(z) = P_0 + zP_1 + \dots$. Horizontality gives

$$z\partial_z P(z) + A(z)^T P(z) + P(z)A(-z) = 0.$$

The z^{-1} coefficient gives $N^T P_0 = P_0 N$. Thus L is isotropic and, in dimension two, $L^\perp = L$. The constant coefficient is

$$A_0^T P_0 + P_0 A_0 + N^T P_1 - P_1 N = 0.$$

Evaluating this identity on (x, x) , where $x \in L = \ker N$, gives $(A_0 x, x) = 0$. Hence $A_0 x \in L^\perp = L$. $\square$

Choose a frame with $L = \langle e_1 \rangle$ and $Ne_2 = \nu e_1$, $\nu \neq 0$. The modified lattice has frame e_1, ze_2 , so

$$A^\sharp = S^{-1}AS - S^{-1}z\partial_z S, \quad S = \text{diag}(1, z). \quad (4.8)$$

The term $z^{-1}N$ becomes regular. The only possible new pole is the E_{21} -coefficient of A_0 , which vanishes by Lemma 4.4. Thus $A^\sharp = R + zR_1 + \dots$. Define

$$\delta^\sharp(E) := (\text{tr } R)^2 - 4 \det R. \quad (4.9)$$

Proposition 4.5 (Rank-two rigidity). *Under formal change of even bulk coordinates, the modified connection is regular in every base direction and*

$$\partial R = [G_\partial, R] \quad (4.10)$$

for a regular matrix G_∂ . Consequently $\partial(\delta^\sharp) = 0$. Regular connection isomorphisms preserve the domain and value of $\delta^\sharp$.

Proof. Write a centered base equation as $\partial y = (z^{-1}C_\partial + C_{\partial,0} + O(z))y$. The z^{-2} coefficient of flatness gives $[N, C_\partial] = 0$, and the trace of the z^{-1} coefficient gives $\text{tr } C_\partial = 0$; here the base equation has been scalar-centered. The commutant of a nonzero rank-one nilpotent 2×2 matrix is the coefficient-field span of I and N , so $C_\partial = q_\partial N$. The same z^{-1} coefficient gives

$$\partial N = -q_\partial N + [N, q_\partial A_0 - C_{\partial,0}].$$

Writing $B = q_\partial A_0 - C_{\partial,0}$, one has $\partial(N^2) = -2q_\partial N^2 + [N^2, B]$; uniqueness for the formal coefficient recursion preserves $N^2 = 0$, while the nonzero leading value prevents N from becoming the zero formal section. Thus formal bulk transport preserves the nonzero square-zero orbit and its image line. After modification, the only possible base pole is $z^{-1}kE_{21}$. If $R = \begin{pmatrix} a & \nu \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$, the z^{-1} flatness equation is $kE_{21} + [R, kE_{21}] = 0$. Its diagonal entries are νk and $-\nu k$, so $k = 0$. The constant term of the flatness equation is now (4.10); trace and determinant are constant under infinitesimal conjugation. A regular isomorphism carries N , L , and the modified lattice to their counterparts and conjugates the residue. $\square$

Proposition 4.6 (Exponent interpretation). *If ρ_1, ρ_2 are the eigenvalues of R , their classes modulo $\mathbf{Z}$ are the formal exponent classes of the original centered block and*

$$\delta^\sharp = (\rho_1 - \rho_2)^2.$$

Proof. The elementary modification uses integral powers of z , so it preserves formal exponent classes modulo $\mathbf{Z}$. The modified connection is regular singular with residue R ; the regular-singular classification identifies the exponent classes with the residue eigenvalues modulo $\mathbf{Z}$ [29, Chapter 3]. The displayed identity is the quadratic discriminant formula. $\square$

For such a block E , write ρ_1, ρ_2 for the eigenvalues of its modified residue in the fixed algebraic closure $\overline{K}$ of the generic coefficient field. Define the fold on each block by

$$w_{\text{at}}(E) = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{rk } E = 2, N \neq 0, N^2 = 0, [\rho_1] \neq [\rho_2] \text{ in } \overline{K}/\mathbf{Z}, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \quad (4.11)$$

and extend it additively to $w_{\text{at}} : \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{at}}} \rightarrow \mathbf{N}$. Put $I_{\text{at}}(Y) = w_{\text{at}}(\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{at}}}(Y))$. Propositions 4.5 and 4.6 make this a lawful marker for Proposition 4.3: conjugation preserves the two residue eigenvalues, while changes of regular-singular lattice and recorded suspensions shift exponents only by integers. The condition $\delta^\sharp \neq 0$ is insufficient: it says only $\rho_1 \neq \rho_2$ and therefore also marks resonant blocks.

4.4 The cubic block

Let $X \subset \mathbf{P}^4$ be a smooth cubic threefold, let $P = H|_X$, and put $q = Q^\ell$ for the line class and $r = (3q)^{1/2}$. Beauville's formulas give [5, main theorem and (2.1)–(2.3)]

$$P \star P = P^2 + 6q, \quad P \star P^2 = P^3 + 15qP, \quad P \star P^3 = 6qP^2 + 36q^2. \quad (4.12)$$

Thus, in the basis $(1, P, P^2, P^3)$,

$$K_X = 2 \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 6q & 0 & 36q^2 \\ 1 & 0 & 15q & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 6q \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad G_X = \frac{1}{2} \text{diag}(3, 1, -1, -3), \quad (4.13)$$

and $z^2 \partial_z S = (K_X + zG_X)S$. This agrees with [9, Section 3].

Proposition 4.7 (Small-even cubic block reduction). *The characteristic and minimal polynomials of K_X are both $T^2(T^2 - 108q)$. After adjoining r , its eigenvalues are $6r, -6r, 0, 0$, and the zero generalized eigenspace is one rank-two Jordan block. A normalized gauge regular in z gives*

$$\begin{aligned} z^2 \partial_z \tilde{S}_+ &= (6r + O(z^2)) \tilde{S}_+, \\ z^2 \partial_z \tilde{S}_- &= (-6r + O(z^2)) \tilde{S}_-, \\ z^2 \partial_z \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{S}_3 \\ \tilde{S}_4 \end{pmatrix} &= [J_0 + zD_0 + z^2E_0 + O(z^3)] \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{S}_3 \\ \tilde{S}_4 \end{pmatrix}, \end{aligned} \quad (4.14)$$

where

$$J_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D_0 = \begin{pmatrix} -19/18 & 0 \\ 0 & 19/18 \end{pmatrix}, \quad E_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -14/(81r^2) \\ -8/81 & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (4.15)$$

Proof. The matrix

$$C = \begin{pmatrix} 6r^3 & -6r^3 & 0 & -7r^2 \\ 7r^2 & 7r^2 & -2r^2 & 0 \\ 3r & -3r & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \det C = -486r^5,$$

puts K_X into

$$C^{-1}K_X C = \begin{pmatrix} 6r & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -6r & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Partition as $1 \mid 1 \mid 2$. At each positive order in z , the off-diagonal gauge coefficient is the unique solution of a Sylvester equation between blocks with disjoint scalar spectra. The gauge and inverse are regular in z ; explicitly, it has the normalized form

$$A(z) = I + \sum_{n \geq 1} A_n z^n, \quad A_n \text{ block-off-diagonal.} \quad (4.16)$$

Direct multiplication through order z^2 gives (4.15). $\square$

For the zero block, $N = J_0 = 2E_{12}$. With $S = \text{diag}(1, z)$,

$$R_X = 2E_{12} + D_0 - \frac{8}{81}E_{21} - \text{diag}(0, 1) = \begin{pmatrix} -19/18 & 2 \\ -8/81 & 1/18 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (4.17)$$

Its characteristic polynomial is $(T + 1/6)(T + 5/6)$. Thus the two exponent classes differ by $2/3 \notin \mathbf{Z}$, so the block is marked; as a numerical check,

$$\boxed{\delta^\#(X) = \frac{4}{9}}, \quad I_{\text{at}}(X) = 1. \quad (4.18)$$

4.5 Center nullity through dimension two

Proposition 4.8 (Low-dimensional nullity). *For every smooth projective Z of dimension at most two and every actual QDM comparison occurrence ω , $I_{\text{at}}(Z; \omega) = 0$.*

Proof. A point has one rank-one block. For $\mathbf{P}^1$, the relation $p \star p = Qe^{t_p}$ gives two rank-one generic blocks.

Let C have genus $g \geq 1$. There is no nonconstant genus-zero map to C , so its even big quantum product is classical. With $\int_C p = 1$ and $a = 2 - 2g$, its centered even connection is

$$z\partial_z Y = \left[z^{-1}aE_{21} + \text{diag}(1/2, -1/2) \right] Y.$$

For $g = 1$, $N = 0$. For $g > 1$, the modification $S = \text{diag}(z, 1)$ gives residue $aE_{21} - \frac{1}{2}I$, of discriminant zero. Its two eigenvalues, and therefore its two exponent classes, are equal. Thus every curve has zero marker.

Let S be a surface with K_S nef. For a quantum-product term with input degree b , non-scalar Euler degree $a \geq 2$, curve class d , and nonunit even bulk degrees $e_\nu \geq 2$, the dimension axiom gives output degree

$$a + b - 2c_1(S) \cdot d + \sum_\nu (e_\nu - 2) \geq b + 2.$$

The centered Euler operator strictly raises ordinary degree. Its only block is the whole even cohomology, of rank $b_0 + b_2 + b_4 \geq 3$, so its marker is zero.

A minimal surface with non-nef canonical class is $\mathbf{P}^2$ or a ruled surface $\mathbf{P}_C(V)$ [6, Chapter VI]. The relation $H^{*3} = Q$ makes $\mathbf{P}^2$ generically semisimple. Formula (4.1) and the curve case give zero for ruled surfaces. Every nonminimal surface is obtained from a minimal one by point blowups; formula (4.2) adds only zero point terms. This proves intrinsic nullity. The faithful character argument identifies every actual center term with a faithful scalar extension of the corresponding intrinsic generic block, and the marker is unchanged by that extension. $\square$

4.6 The projective endpoint and the contradiction

Formula (4.1) applied to $X \times \mathbf{P}^1 = \mathbf{P}_X(\mathcal{O}_X^{\oplus 2})$ gives

$$I_{\text{at}}(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 2. \quad (4.19)$$

On the other hand, $QH^\bullet(\mathbf{P}^4) = \Lambda[H]/(H^5 - Q)$. At $Q \neq 0$, multiplication by $5H$ has five distinct eigenvalues after algebraic closure. Thus

$$I_{\text{at}}(\mathbf{P}^4) = 0. \quad (4.20)$$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Proposition 4.8 kills every actual center correction in a weak factorization of smooth projective fourfolds. Hence Theorem 4.2 makes I_{at} birationally invariant. If $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ were rational, then

$$2 = I_{\text{at}}(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = I_{\text{at}}(\mathbf{P}^4) = 0,$$

a contradiction. □

Remark 4.9 (Scope). The marker, center theorem, and weak-factorization application above are strictly for one stabilization. No statement concerns a second or an arbitrary stabilization.

5 Framed formal monodromy: a conditional refinement

Section 4 proved the occurrence-indexed marker-ledger theorem and applied its rank-two formal-exponent fold. We now keep the ledger construction and target monoid $A = \mathbf{N}$ fixed, refine the block type by a marked small section and loop framing, and replace the fold by primitive-sixth framed formal-monodromy multiplicity. The argument is therefore a second specialization of Theorem 4.2, not a parallel weak-factorization proof.

The Iritani and Iritani–Koto comparison isomorphisms preserve the original loop framing after coefficient-field extension. The string and divisor equations remove the scalar degree-zero term and every fixed degree-two term whose Novikov character descends to the coefficient ring. The additional inputs needed to make the operation formulas compatible with this finer fold are a residual reconstruction-tail displacement and a logically separate specialization step in the divisor-tagging argument. These are Hypotheses 5.7R and 5.7T.

The framed conclusion is logically subordinate to Theorem 1.1. Definition 5.1, the cubic computation, and the product-with-projective-space formula below are unconditional. The projective-bundle and blowup operation formulas use Hypothesis 5.7R. We prove specialized low-dimensional vanishing directly, without Hypothesis 5.7T, for nef-canonical targets, for $\mathbf{P}^1$ and $\mathbf{P}^2$, for every rational geometrically ruled surface—for F_1 on specializations that are graded-monomial in the sense of Definition 5.10, as every center specialization is—and, assuming only Hypothesis 5.7R, for ruled surfaces over curves of positive genus. In the present proof Hypothesis 5.7T is used only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. Consequently the resulting birational invariance of ν_6 , and the identification $\nu_6(V) = 2$ for genus-eight Fano threefolds, remain conditional on Hypothesis 5.7R and on Hypothesis 5.7T for those centers.

Proposition 4.6 explains how the two folds are related on the cubic rank-two block. The atomic fold tests whether the two formal exponent classes are distinct modulo $\mathbf{Z}$. The auxiliary quantity $\delta^\sharp$ is the square of the difference of the residue representatives selected by the canonical elementary modification; for the cubic it equals $4/9$. The framed invariant ν_6 is finer: it tests the absolute cyclotomic placement of the formal exponent classes, together

with descent data for the original loop framing when ramification is present. For the cubic zero block, Section 4 already finds the representatives $-1/6$ and $-5/6$; the calculation below recovers those same exponents directly from formal solutions and records that their classes give the two primitive sixth roots. Thus Sections 4 and 5 use two levels of the same formal data rather than unrelated numerical obstructions.

Let T be a smooth projective variety. Write

$$\Lambda_T = \mathbf{C}[[\mathrm{NE}_{\mathrm{num}}^{\mathbf{Z}}(T)]]$$

for the completed monoid ring of the image of effective homology classes in the numerical curve lattice

$$N_1(T) = \mathrm{im}(H_2(T, \mathbf{Z}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(\mathrm{NS}(T)/\mathrm{tors}, \mathbf{Z})).$$

Thus $N_1(T)$ is torsion-free and is separated by integral divisors. The completed monoid ring Λ_T is a domain. Indeed, the effective numerical monoid embeds in the torsion-free lattice $N_1(T)$, hence is cancellative and its ordinary monoid algebra is a domain. An ample degree is positive and proper on the effective numerical monoid, so every nonzero completed series has a lowest nonzero homogeneous part, with only finitely many monomials in that degree. The lowest homogeneous part of a product is the product of the two lowest homogeneous parts and is nonzero in the monoid algebra. Therefore $\mathrm{Frac}(\Lambda_T)$ is defined. Let $\mathcal{K}_T$ be an algebraic closure of this fraction field. The loop coordinate z remains independent: in particular, $\mathcal{K}_T$ contains no chosen root of z . We first isolate the cyclotomic part of formal monodromy without choosing values for the exponentials of arbitrary elements of $\mathcal{K}_T$.

Let $K \supset \mathbf{C}$ be an algebraically closed field of characteristic zero. Choose a complement $K = \mathbf{C} \oplus V$ of $\mathbf{Q}$ -vector spaces, let $K[V]$ be the group algebra of the additive group of V , and let Ω_V be an algebraic closure of its fraction field. Thus $K \subset \Omega_V$. The map

$$\mathrm{Exp}_V(c + v) = e^{2\pi i c}[v]: (K, +) \longrightarrow \Omega_V^\times$$

is a group homomorphism. Since V is torsion-free, $K[V]$ is a domain, and its distinct monomials are linearly independent. Consequently

$$\ker(\mathrm{Exp}_V) = \mathbf{Z}, \quad \mathrm{Exp}_V(a) \text{ is a root of unity} \iff a \in \mathbf{Q}.$$

Apply Levelt–Turrittin after a ramification $z = w^e$. In the formal decomposition, write the residue on a regular-singular block as $R = R_s + R_n$, with commuting semisimple and nilpotent parts. In the universal formal solution algebra, define a full turn of w on that block by

$$M_{\mathrm{RS}, V} = \mathrm{Exp}_V(R_s) \exp(2\pi i R_n),$$

where Exp_V is applied to the eigenvalues of R_s . The lift of one turn of the original z -disc acts on the formal symbols by $w \mapsto e^{2\pi i/e} w$, and on the blocks by their descent intertwiners. Its e -th power is $M_{\mathrm{RS}, V}$ on every returned regular-singular block. An integral change of residue representative multiplies the formal solution by an integral power of w , so it conjugates this lifted action rather than changing it. Since the coefficient and descent matrices lie in $K \subset \Omega_V$, this defines the framed operator $M_{f, V}$ over Ω_V . Ramified exponential factors are thereby permuted rather than made single-valued by changing the frame.

Choice independence. For every root of unity $\zeta \in \mathbf{C}$, its algebraic multiplicity as an eigenvalue of $M_{f, V}$ is independent of the complement V , the Levelt–Turrittin ramification and decomposition, and the algebraic closure Ω_V . It is also unchanged when the chosen algebraic closure of the original coefficient field is replaced by a common algebraically closed overfield. When $K = \mathbf{C}$, it is the usual multiplicity in the analytic formal monodromy on

the original z -disc. We use here the functoriality and uniqueness of the ramified formal decomposition. That statement holds over any algebraically closed coefficient field of characteristic zero, which is the algebraic form we need, and in that generality it is the formal classification of differential modules over $K((z))$ [29, Chapter 3]. Sabbah gives the complex-analytic account, where the same decomposition appears alongside the Riemann–Hilbert correspondence [33, Lecture 5, Section 5.c, proofs of Theorem 5.8 and Proposition 5.10]. Consider one orbit of Levelt–Turrittin blocks under a turn of the original disc, let d be its length, and write $A_i : E_i \rightarrow E_{i+1}$ for its successive deck/descent maps, with indices modulo d . Put $U = A_{d-1} \cdots A_0$ on E_0 . A cyclic-block determinant gives

$$\chi_{\bigoplus_i E_i}(X) = \det(X^d I - U).$$

Put $r = e/d$. Equivariance of the descent datum gives the intrinsic return relation

$$U^r = M_{\text{RS},V}.$$

Thus, if μ is an eigenvalue of U , then $\mu^r = \text{Exp}_V(\rho)$ for a residue exponent ρ , with algebraic multiplicities read on the corresponding generalized eigenspaces. If a root of unity ζ occurs in (5), then $\mu = \zeta^d$ and $\text{Exp}_V(\rho) = \zeta^e$; hence $\rho \in \mathbf{Q}$ by (5). Conversely, if ρ is rational, then μ^r is torsion, so every corresponding μ , and hence every root of $X^d - \mu$, is torsion. On these rational residue classes Exp_V is the usual complex exponential; the finite descent operator is the same intrinsic operator. The exact roots of unity and their algebraic multiplicities are therefore those of the ordinary complex construction. Nonrational residue classes contribute no root of unity. This criterion does not depend on V and does not require a fractional residue factor to commute with the descent action.

Compare two Levelt–Turrittin choices after pulling both to a common ramification $z = \tilde{w}^E$. Equivariant uniqueness of the formal decomposition identifies their total horizontal solution spaces and carries the original- z -turn deck/descent operator for one choice to the scalar extension of the other. Thus the product of all orbit polynomials (5), rather than any individually labelled return map, is invariant under refinement and re-decomposition. The same argument after a common algebraically closed coefficient extension preserves the intrinsic multiset of residue classes and finite descent characters. The relation (5) is itself invariant under integral changes of residue representative. Hence the cyclotomic test above and its algebraic multiplicities depend only on the original framed module, not on the coefficient closure or complement. Finally, for $K = \mathbf{C}$ one has $V = 0$ and $\text{Exp}_V(a) = e^{2\pi i a}$, which gives the usual analytic formal monodromy.

Definition 5.1. Apply the preceding construction to the small even quantum connection over $\mathcal{K}_T((z))$, and put

$$\nu_6(T) = \text{mult}_{e^{\pi i/3}} M_{\text{f},V}(T) + \text{mult}_{e^{-\pi i/3}} M_{\text{f},V}(T).$$

The multiplicities are algebraic multiplicities in the characteristic polynomial. The choice-independence argument above makes their sum independent of all the auxiliary choices.

Let $\mathcal{T}_{\text{fr}}$ be the refinement of the generic-even block type whose objects retain the chosen small section and original z -disc framing, and whose morphisms preserve both. Let $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{fr}}}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{fr}}}$ be its groupoid and effective block monoid. For a block E of this type, let $w_6(E)$ be the same sum of the two primitive-sixth algebraic multiplicities, and extend blockwise:

$$w_6 : \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{fr}}} \rightarrow \mathbf{N}, \quad \nu_6(T) = w_6(\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{fr}}}(T)).$$

Direct-sum additivity of characteristic polynomials makes w_6 a commutative-monoid fold. Lemma 5 shows that it is preserved by the regular scalar extensions and formal-coordinate

isomorphisms in the common QDM construction. Neither marked datum is forgotten when passing to $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{fr}}}$.

The frame matters. Adjoining roots of Novikov monomials is an algebraic coefficient extension and is harmless by choice independence. Adjoining a root of z , by contrast, would replace the original loop and could erase the deck part of the operator.

Lemma 5.1A (Frame transport over a coefficient field). *Let $K \supset \mathbf{C}$ be an algebraically closed field of characteristic zero, and let D, D' be differential modules over $K((z))$. Suppose $G \in \text{GL}_n(K((z)))$ is a gauge isomorphism from D to D' . Then the framed operators $M_{\text{f},V}(D)$ and $M_{\text{f},V}(D')$, defined using the original z -disc turn, are conjugate after passage to a common coefficient extension. In particular the algebraic multiplicity of every root of unity is the same for D and D' .*

Proof. After a common Levelt–Turrittin ramification, choose a formal solution matrix Y for D in the formal solution algebra used in Definition 5.1, and let σ denote one turn of the original z -disc. Since G has entries in $K((z))$, $\sigma(G) = G$. Hence

$$\sigma(GY) = G\sigma(Y).$$

Thus GY is a solution frame for D' in which the original-disc turn has the same matrix as in the frame Y . Comparing with any other solution frame for D' conjugates that matrix by a constant matrix. Therefore the framed operators are conjugate and have the same characteristic polynomial. $\square$

Lemma 5.2 (Exact string and fixed-divisor shifts). *Let a pullback of the even quantum connection of a smooth projective variety T be defined over a coefficient field containing its Novikov coefficients.*

- (i) *Replacing a bulk point τ by $\tau + c\mathbf{1}$ changes the z -connection only by the scalar irregular twist $e^{-c/z}$. Hence it does not change the framed formal-monodromy eigenvalues on the original z -disc, for any coefficient c for which the shifted connection is defined.*
- (ii) *Let $D \in H^2(T) \otimes K$ be a bulk shift such that $d \mapsto e^{\langle D, d \rangle}$ defines a multiplicative character on the numerical Novikov image in the coefficient field. Then the connection at $\tau + D$ is obtained from that at τ by the coefficient substitution*

$$Q^d \mapsto e^{\langle D, d \rangle} Q^d.$$

This substitution fixes $\mathbf{C}$, so it preserves the algebraic multiplicities of every root of unity in framed formal monodromy.

Proof. Write the quantum connection in the convention of [22, (2.2)–(2.3) and Remark 2.3]. The String Equation implies that the quantum product is independent of the H^0 coordinate, while the Euler field acquires $c\mathbf{1}$. Thus the horizontal equation $z^2 \partial_z Y = (U - z\mu)Y$ acquires the scalar term cI , and multiplication of a solution by $e^{-c/z}$ gives the shifted equation. This exponential is single-valued under a full turn of the original z -disc and changes no regular exponent or descent datum.

For a degree-two shift, the Divisor Equation says that the quantum product depends on the divisor coordinate only through the combinations $Q^d e^{\langle D, d \rangle}$; the degree-two coordinate does not occur in the Euler field. Therefore the full z -connection is the coefficient base change displayed above. The induced embedding of coefficient fields fixes the complex roots of unity, and choice independence in Definition 5.1 gives the last assertion. $\square$

Remark 5.3 (Why a residual hypothesis remains). Flatness does give a normalized gauge for a genuinely formal bulk germ. Writing the formal bulk variables collectively as η and solving

$$\partial_{\eta_i} G = -z^{-1}(\phi_i \star_{\eta}) G, \quad G|_{\eta=0} = I,$$

recursively, the coefficient of total bulk degree m has no power of z below $-m$. Thus every fixed bulk degree uses only integral powers of the original loop coordinate and is harmless for framing. After substituting a reconstruction coordinate containing Novikov coefficients, however, the sum over all bulk degrees need not have a uniform lower Laurent bound in z . We therefore do not promote this degreewise gauge to an element of a Laurent series field and do not use it to identify intrinsic framed monodromy at a reconstruction value. Hypotheses 5.7R and 5.7T below isolate exactly the two places where such an identification is still required. The rank-two theorem below avoids this gauge altogether on the formal germ where it applies.

Lemma 5.4 (Numerical Novikov base change). *The quotient from the effective homology monoid to its image in $N_1(T)$ extends continuously to completed monoid rings, and the quantum connection and the two comparison theorems base-change along it.*

Proof. Filter both monoids by intersection with an ample divisor. Effective homology classes below a fixed cutoff form a finite set, as follows from the finite-type Chow varieties of cycles of bounded degree. The quotient is therefore defined on every truncated monoid ring and passes to the inverse limit. Explicitly, the coefficient of $Q^{\bar{d}}$ in the image of $\sum_d a_d Q^d$ is

$$\sum_{d \rightarrow \bar{d}} a_d.$$

The sum is finite at every cutoff, and additivity of the quotient makes this coefficient-wise pushforward a unital homomorphism for completed convolution. Thus the quantum products descend by grouping Gromov–Witten coefficients with the same numerical class. Pushforward of curves, pairing with $c_1(N_{C/T})$, and the derivations $Q\partial_Q$ are constant on these fibres. At each cutoff, apply the resulting ring homomorphism to the comparison map and to its stated inverse. Scalar extension preserves their two inverse identities. Grouping coefficients identifies the scalar-extended quantum module with the numerical quantum module, and the preceding fiberwise constancy identifies its connection operators and divisor substitutions. Passing through the compatible cutoffs proves the asserted completed base change. $\square$

Proposition 5.5 (Formal-germ rigidity of an isolated rank-two packet). *Let K be an algebraically closed coefficient field of characteristic zero and let the even quantum connection be pulled back to a formal smooth bulk germ $B = K[[t_1, \dots, t_m]]$. Suppose that at the closed point the Euler operator has an eigenvalue whose generalized eigenspace has rank two, its nilpotent part is a single nonzero Jordan block, and every other Euler eigenvalue differs from it by a unit of K . Then the corresponding rank-two spectral cluster remains a single nonzero Jordan block on the formal germ. After scalar centering and the canonical elementary modification of Section 4, its residue R has constant characteristic polynomial on B . Consequently the algebraic multiplicities of the primitive sixth roots contributed by this block are constant on the formal germ.*

Proof. The unit separation from the other Euler eigenvalues gives a formal spectral projector onto the rank-two cluster. Put $U_0 = \lambda I + N$ on this cluster, with $\text{tr } N = 0$, and let C_a denote quantum multiplication by the bulk tangent vector ∂_{t_a} . Flatness gives the coefficient identities

$$[U, C_a] = 0, \quad \partial_{t_a} U = C_a + [C_a, \mu].$$

Let P be the formal spectral projector onto this cluster and use the induced connection D_a on $P(H)$. For an endomorphism preserving the cluster, D_a is the projected derivative, so

$$D_a U_0 = P(\partial_{t_a} U)P.$$

Because $[U, C_a] = 0$, the operator C_a commutes with P . Compressing the second flatness identity therefore gives

$$D_a U_0 = C_{a,0} + [C_{a,0}, \mu_0], \quad C_{a,0} = PC_a P, \quad \mu_0 = P\mu P.$$

Because the reduction of U_0 at the closed point is nonscalar, U_0 is a regular 2×2 matrix over the local ring B . After choosing the closed-point Jordan frame, one off-diagonal entry of N is a unit; solving $[N, X] = 0$ directly in that frame gives the commutant $BI \oplus BN$. Hence

$$C_{a,0} = p_a I + q_a N.$$

Taking traces in the block evolution gives $p_a = \partial_{t_a} \lambda$ and therefore

$$D_a N = q_a N + q_a [N, \mu_0].$$

Set $d = \det N$. Since determinant is invariant under change of frame, its ordinary derivative can be computed with the covariant derivative D_a . For a traceless 2×2 matrix, $\text{adj}(N) = -N$ and $N^2 = -dI$. Cyclicity of trace then gives

$$\partial_{t_a} d = \text{tr}(\text{adj}(N) D_a N) = 2q_a d.$$

Since d vanishes at the closed point, a lowest-homogeneous-term argument in $K[[t_1, \dots, t_m]]$ forces $d = 0$. Thus $N^2 = 0$ everywhere. A matrix entry of N is a unit at the closed point, so N remains nonzero and its image is a line subbundle.

The proof of Proposition 4.5 is purely algebraic: it uses only flatness, Frobenius self-adjointness, anti-self-adjointness of the grading operator, and the nondegenerate Poincaré pairing on the separated spectral factor. Those identities hold coefficientwise over the present formal germ, so the same elementary modification is regular in every base direction and its residue satisfies

$$D_a R = [G_a, R].$$

Hence $\text{tr } R$ and $\det R$, and therefore the characteristic polynomial of R , are constant. By Proposition 4.6, the residue eigenvalues are representatives of the formal exponent classes; the integral shear changes them only by integers. The eigenvalues of the regular formal monodromy are therefore constant, including in resonant cases where only the unipotent part could vary. This proves the cyclotomic multiplicity statement. $\square$

Remark 5.6 (Formal-germ scope). Proposition 5.5 is deliberately a theorem over a formal bulk germ with a fixed coefficient field. It does not identify an Iritani or Iritani–Koto reconstruction value with a point of that germ. The comparison theorems are formulated over graded Laurent completions in Novikov variables, whereas the proposition deforms genuinely formal bulk variables over K . Substituting a Laurent–Novikov reconstruction expression for those formal variables is an additional operation, and no theorem legitimizing that substitution for framed monodromy is assumed here. Thus the proposition proves the local rank-two mechanism behind Hypothesis 5.7R; it is not a proof of that hypothesis at a reconstruction value.

Hypothesis 5.7R (Reconstruction-tail invariance). *Consider only the residual reconstruction displacements that occur in the blowup and projective-bundle decompositions used in Proposition 5.7: the $O(u) + s_j$ tails on the target summands and the corresponding residual ambient shift, after the scalar H^0 term and every fixed H^2 term whose Novikov character descends to the relevant coefficient ring have been removed by Lemma 5.2. After the coefficient specialization displayed in the construction, replacing zero bulk by one of these residual reconstruction displacements does not change the algebraic multiplicities of $e^{\pi i/3}$ and $e^{-\pi i/3}$ in framed formal monodromy on the original z -disc.*

No invariance under an arbitrary bulk displacement is asserted.

Proposition 5.7 (Framed operation formulas, conditional). *Assume Hypothesis 5.7R. Let $V \rightarrow T$ be a vector bundle of rank $r \geq 2$. Then*

$$\nu_6(\mathbf{P}_T(V)) = r\nu_6(T).$$

Let $\tilde{T} = \text{Bl}_C T$, where $C \subset T$ is smooth of codimension $c \geq 2$. In Iritani's comparison field one has

$$\nu_6(\tilde{T}) = \nu_6(T) + \sum_{j=0}^{c-2} \nu_6(C; \chi_j),$$

where χ_j is the numerical Novikov specialization of the j -th center summand. The endpoint terms in (5.7) are the intrinsic small invariants; the center terms are computed after the displayed specializations.

Proof. Proposition 4.3 supplies the common direct-sum, coefficient-spine, parity, and occurrence bookkeeping. Lemma 5 shows that the fold w_6 crosses its regular comparison maps without changing the original z -disc. It remains only to compare the reconstructed bulk points with the intrinsic small sections.

For a blowup center summand put $u = q^{-1/(c-1)}$. Iritani's coordinates have the initial form

$$\varsigma_j = \varsigma_j^\circ + s_j, \quad \varsigma_j^\circ = -(c-1)\lambda_j + h_{C,j} + O(u),$$

with $\lambda_j = \zeta_j u^{-1}$ [22, Section 5.8.2 and (5.27)–(5.30)], with numerical specialization

$$\chi_j(Q_C^d) = Q^{i^*d} u^{\rho_C \cdot d}.$$

Lemma 5.2 removes the scalar term and the fixed divisor $h_{C,j}$ exactly. The latter character descends through (5) because $h_{C,j}$ is a scalar multiple of ρ_C . Section 5.8.1 of [22] fixes the logarithmic normalization. Hypothesis 5.7R is invoked exactly for the remaining $O(u) + s_j$ tail, and analogously for the residual ambient tail $\tau^\circ = O(q^{-1})$. Additivity of w_6 now gives (5.7). The center term retains χ_j , since the map (5) need not be injective.

For a projective bundle put $u = q^{-1/r}$. Iritani–Koto's reconstruction coordinates satisfy

$$\varsigma_j = \varsigma_j^\circ + s_j, \quad \varsigma_j^\circ = r\lambda_j - \frac{2\pi i j}{r} c_1(V) + O(u)$$

[24, Theorem 5.1(4), Proposition 5.6]. The exact shift lemma removes the first two terms, while [24, (5.11)–(5.12)] fixes the initial coordinate. Hypothesis 5.7R is used only for the residual $O(u) + s_j$ tail. The base Novikov map is injective [24, (1.1) and Remark 5.2], so each of the r ledger blocks contributes $\nu_6(T)$. This proves (5.7). $\square$

The center map in (5.7) is not necessarily injective [22, (5.15)]. Thus generic vanishing for C does not by itself imply that its specialized term vanishes. The next lemma supplies the missing implication.

Definition 5.8. A monomial map $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ is *strictly Novikov-admissible* if A is a complete separated valued $\mathbf{C}$ -domain with domain associated graded, every monomial has nonzero image, and

$$v(\chi(Q^d)) = \ell(d),$$

where ℓ is positive and proper on the effective numerical monoid.

We write $\nu_6(T; \chi)$ for the framed small-even invariant after scalar extension along such a map.

The center maps in (5.7) are strictly admissible. Give the exceptional Laurent variable valuation zero and use an ample divisor H on T . Then

$$v_H(Q^{i_*d} q^{-\rho_C \cdot d/(c-1)}) = (H|_C) \cdot d.$$

The restriction $H|_C$ is ample, which gives positivity and properness; the associated graded Laurent monoid ring is a domain.

Proposition 5.9 (Direct specialized low-dimensional vanishing). *Let $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ be strictly Novikov-admissible.*

(i) *If the canonical divisor K_T is nef, then*

$$\nu_6(T; \chi) = 0$$

unconditionally.

(ii) *If $T = \mathbf{P}^1$ or $T = \mathbf{P}^2$, then*

$$\nu_6(T; \chi) = 0$$

unconditionally.

(iii) *Let $T = \mathbf{P}_C(V)$ be a geometrically ruled surface with $g(C) \geq 1$. Assuming Hypothesis 5.7R,*

$$\nu_6(T; \chi) = 0.$$

Proof. For (i), work after scalar extension to an algebraic closure of $\text{Frac } A$. At small bulk write

$$\nabla_{z\partial_z} = z\partial_z - z^{-1}U + \text{Gr}, \quad U = \sum_{\beta} \chi(Q^{\beta})U_{\beta},$$

where U_{β} is the coefficient of Euler multiplication in numerical class β . Put

$$g = \text{Gr} + \frac{1}{2}E,$$

with E equal to the identity on cohomological degrees of parity opposite to $\dim T$ and zero on the other parity. The operator g has integral eigenvalues. The genus-zero dimension constraint gives

$$U_{\beta} : H^i(T) \longrightarrow H^{i+2-2c_1(T) \cdot \beta}(T),$$

so, because quantum multiplication preserves parity, U_{β} raises g -weight by

$$m_{\beta} = 1 - c_1(T) \cdot \beta.$$

If K_T is nef, then $m_{\beta} \geq 1$ for every effective β . Make the half-parity correction explicitly by replacing the z -connection with

$$\nabla_{z\partial_z}^{\text{par}} = \nabla_{z\partial_z} + \frac{1}{2}E = z\partial_z - z^{-1}U + g.$$

With the gauge convention $G\nabla G^{-1}$, take $G = z^g$. Since $[g, U_\beta] = m_\beta U_\beta$, one has

$$z^g U_\beta z^{-g} = z^{m_\beta} U_\beta, \quad z^g (z \partial_z) z^{-g} = z \partial_z - g,$$

and therefore

$$z^g \nabla_{z \partial_z}^{\text{par}} z^{-g} = z \partial_z - \sum_{\beta} \chi(Q^\beta) z^{m_\beta - 1} U_\beta.$$

Thus the specialized connection is regular singular. This conclusion is unchanged when the noninjective map χ groups several numerical classes: every grouped summand still has nonnegative z -order. The residue consists only of the terms with $m_\beta = 1$, equivalently $c_1(T) \cdot \beta = 0$. Each such operator raises the finite g -filtration by one, so their sum is nilpotent. The parity-corrected regular monodromy is therefore unipotent. Undoing the half-parity correction permits only eigenvalues 1 and -1 , because the transformed residue preserves parity. Hence no primitive sixth root occurs. Strict Novikov-admissibility is used here only to ensure that the specialized small connection is a well-defined coefficientwise specialization; injectivity is not used.

For (ii), let ℓ be the line class and put $a = \chi(Q^\ell)$. Strict admissibility gives $a \neq 0$. Over an algebraic closure of $\text{Frac } A$, the specialized small quantum relations are $H^2 = a$ for $\mathbf{P}^1$ and $H^3 = a$ for $\mathbf{P}^2$. Thus Euler multiplication has respectively two and three distinct eigenvalues. Every spectral block has rank one, so Lemma 5.20 gives trivial framed regular monodromy on every block.

For (iii), let f be the fibre class. Every map from a connected nodal genus-zero curve to C is constant: it is constant on every irreducible rational component, and connectedness forces the same image point on all components. Hence every nonzero curve class contributing to the genus-zero quantum product of T is a positive multiple of f . The small quantum differential module is therefore obtained by scalar extension from a one-variable module over $\mathbf{C}[[Q^f]]$. The restriction of χ to the fibre ray is injective, because

$$v(\chi(Q^{nf})) = n\ell(f), \quad \ell(f) > 0,$$

so distinct powers have distinct valuation. On the other hand, Hypothesis 5.7R and Proposition 5.7 give the intrinsic projective-bundle identity

$$\nu_6(T) = 2\nu_6(C) = 0,$$

where the last equality follows by applying (i) to the identity Novikov specialization of C , since K_C is nef for $g(C) \geq 1$. The intrinsic small module and the χ -specialized module are both scalar extensions of this same one-variable differential module. More explicitly, let

$$K_f = \text{Frac}(\mathbf{C}[[Q^f]]), \quad K_{f,\chi} = \text{Frac}(\chi(\mathbf{C}[[Q^f]])) \subset \text{Frac}(A).$$

The injective restriction of χ identifies K_f with $K_{f,\chi}$. Via this identification, choose a common algebraically closed overfield Ω containing K_f and $\text{Frac}(A)$. After scalar extension to Ω , the intrinsic one-variable module and its χ -specialization become literally the same differential module. Definition 5.1 and its choice-independence under common coefficient-field extension therefore give identical root-of-unity multiplicities. The specialized value also vanishes. $\square$

The remaining centers are the rational geometrically ruled surfaces, that is the Hirzebruch surfaces $F_a = \mathbf{P}_{\mathbf{P}^1}(\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(a))$; these are the minimal surfaces not yet covered, together with F_1 , which is geometrically ruled without being minimal. For those the projective-bundle comparison is available only intrinsically, so we compute the specialized Euler spectrum instead. The quadric surface $F_0 = \mathbf{P}^1 \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is handled separately by the Gromov–Witten product formula, because χ may send its two ruling classes to the same value and the

quartic below then degenerates. For $a \geq 1$ two facts carry the computation: one deformation carries the genus-zero theory of F_a to that of F_0 or F_1 , whose quantum relations serve as the base cases, under an explicit change of Novikov variables, and the resulting rank-four Euler quartic is separable away from one explicit locus that no center specialization meets.

One case, the surface F_1 , needs a mild extra condition on χ , used only to rule out a single algebraic coincidence in the associated graded ring. The word *monomial* in Definition 5.8 refers to the source, a map defined on Novikov monomials; the condition below is about the target, so we call it graded-monomial.

Definition 5.10. A strictly Novikov-admissible $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ is *graded-monomial* if the associated graded ring $\text{gr } A$ admits a $\mathbf{C}$ -basis B containing the leading term $\text{gr } \chi(Q^d)$ of $\chi(Q^d)$ for every effective class d .

Lemma 5.11 (Center specializations are graded-monomial). *The specializations (5) are graded-monomial.*

Proof. The leading term of $\chi_j(Q_C^d) = Q^{i*d} u^{\rho_C \cdot d}$ is its coefficient-one Laurent monomial in the associated graded of A . Distinct such monomials are $\mathbf{C}$ -linearly independent, even though the valuation-zero variable u allows the degree-zero coefficients of the completion to be larger than $\mathbf{C}[u^{\pm 1}]$. Extend this linearly independent set to a $\mathbf{C}$ -basis of $\text{gr } A$. The resulting basis contains the leading term of every effective center monomial. $\square$

Lemma 5.12 (Specialized Euler spectrum of a Hirzebruch surface). *Let $T = F_a = \mathbf{P}_{\mathbf{P}^1}(\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(a))$ with $a \geq 0$, let f and s be the class of a fibre and the class of a section of self-intersection $-a$ in $N_1(T)$, and put $k = \lfloor a/2 \rfloor$. For $a = 0$ either ruling may be taken as the fibre; the quartic below is symmetric in u and w . Let $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ be strictly Novikov-admissible and set*

$$u = \chi(Q^f), \quad w = \chi(Q^{s+kf}).$$

After scalar extension to an algebraic closure of $\text{Frac } A$, the characteristic polynomial of Euler multiplication on $H^0(T) \oplus H^2(T) \oplus H^4(T)$ is

$$P_a(X) = \begin{cases} X^4 - 8(u+w)X^2 + 16(u-w)^2, & a \text{ even}, \\ X^4 + wX^3 - 8uX^2 - 36uwX + 16u^2 - 27uw^2, & a \text{ odd}, \end{cases}$$

and its discriminant is

$$\text{disc } P_a = \begin{cases} 2^{24} u^2 w^2 (u-w)^2, & a \text{ even}, \\ -u^2 w^2 (256u + 27w^2)^3, & a \text{ odd}. \end{cases}$$

Proof. Write F and S for the divisor classes corresponding to f and s , the class of a fibre and the class of the section of self-intersection $-a$, so that $F^2 = 0$, $S \cdot F = 1$, $S^2 = -a$ and $c_1(T) = 2S + (a+2)F$. Put $S^b = S + kF$, of self-intersection $-a + 2k \in \{0, -1\}$; then

$$c_1(T) = \begin{cases} 2S^b + 2F, & a = 2k, \\ 2S^b + 3F, & a = 2k + 1. \end{cases}$$

A single deformation to $a \leq 1$. Let $a \geq 2$. Since $k \geq 1$ and $a - k \geq 1$, a general pair of sections of $\mathcal{O}(k)$ and $\mathcal{O}(a-k)$ has no common zero, so it defines an injection $\mathcal{O} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(k) \oplus \mathcal{O}(a-k)$ with locally free quotient, necessarily $\mathcal{O}(a)$ by degree. Let $\varepsilon \in \text{Ext}^1(\mathcal{O}(a), \mathcal{O})$ be the class of the resulting extension and consider the extensions E_t with class $t\varepsilon$, $t \in \mathbf{A}^1$, that is the pullback of the universal extension along $t \mapsto t\varepsilon$. These form a vector bundle on

$\mathbf{P}^1 \times \mathbf{A}^1$. Scaling a nonzero extension class by a unit leaves the middle term unchanged, so $E_t \cong E_1$ for every $t \neq 0$. The extension is nonsplit, since $\mathcal{O}(k) \oplus \mathcal{O}(a-k)$ is not $\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(a)$, so $\varepsilon \neq 0$. The projectivization of the family is smooth and projective, with

$$\mathbf{P}(E_0) = \mathbf{P}(\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(a)) = F_a, \quad \mathbf{P}(E_t) = \mathbf{P}(\mathcal{O}(k) \oplus \mathcal{O}(a-k)) \cong F_{a-2k} \quad (t \neq 0),$$

the last isomorphism by twisting with $\mathcal{O}(-k)$. Genus-zero Gromov–Witten invariants are invariants of a deformation class [26, Chapter 7]; a smooth projective family carries a smooth family of Kähler forms, and every symplectic four-manifold is semipositive, so the genus-zero invariants of [26] are defined and deformation-invariant for this family. The invariants therefore agree under the parallel transport ψ of N_1 along the family. The ruling is global over the base, so ψ fixes f ; writing $\psi(s) = \alpha s_0 + \beta f$ with s_0 the negative-section class of F_{a-2k} , which for F_0 means the other ruling class, pairing with f gives $\alpha = 1$ and $\psi(s)^2 = -a$ gives $\beta = -k$. Thus

$$\psi(mf + ns) = (m - nk)f + ns_0, \quad \psi(f) = f, \quad \psi(s + kf) = s_0,$$

and correspondingly $S^\flat \mapsto S_0$, the negative section of $F_{a-2k} = F_{a \bmod 2}$ as a divisor class. For $a \leq 1$ take ψ to be the identity.

The two base cases. For $F_0 = \mathbf{P}^1 \times \mathbf{P}^1$ the Gromov–Witten product formula [7] gives $QH^*(F_0) = QH^*(\mathbf{P}^1) \otimes QH^*(\mathbf{P}^1)$, so

$$S_0 \star S_0 = Q^f, \quad F \star F = Q^{s_0}.$$

For F_1 , which is Fano, the toric quantum Stanley–Reisner presentation of [4, Section 5]—established for Fano toric manifolds by the mirror theorem [17, Theorem 0.1]—gives

$$S_0 \star S_0 + S_0 \star F = Q^f, \quad F \star F = Q^{s_0} S_0.$$

The same two relations can be read off directly from the genus-zero invariants of F_1 , which is how we use them; the toric presentation is recorded as a check. On F_1 , $c_1 \cdot (mf + ns_0) = 2m + n$, so a three-point invariant with two divisor insertions and $\beta \neq 0$ is nonzero only for $1 \leq 2m + n \leq 2$; the contributing classes are s_0 , with $\langle \rangle_{s_0} = 1$ because the negative section is the unique curve in its class, and f , with $\langle \text{pt} \rangle_f = 1$ because one fibre passes through a general point. The class $2s_0$ contributes nothing, since every stable map in it has image the negative section and a general point is not on that curve. The divisor axiom then gives $S_0 \star S_0 = -\text{pt} + Q^{s_0} S_0 + Q^f$, $S_0 \star F = \text{pt} - Q^{s_0} S_0$ and $F \star F = Q^{s_0} S_0$, which is the displayed presentation.

Truncation. The transported theory determines the small quantum product of F_a itself, and only finitely many Novikov monomials survive. By the virtual dimension count, and by the fundamental-class axiom at the lower end, a three-point invariant of F_a with two divisor insertions and $\beta \neq 0$ vanishes unless $1 \leq c_1(T) \cdot \beta \leq 2$; and by deformation invariance it vanishes unless $\psi(\beta)$ is effective on $F_{a \bmod 2}$, that is unless $m \geq nk$ and $n \geq 0$ for $\beta = mf + ns$. Now

$$c_1(T) \cdot \beta = 2m + (2 - a)n = \begin{cases} 2(m - nk) + 2n, & a = 2k, \\ 2(m - nk) + n, & a = 2k + 1, \end{cases}$$

so $c_1(T) \cdot \beta \leq 2$ forces $n \leq 1$ for a even and $n \leq 2$ for a odd, and then $m = nk$ except for $\beta = f$. The surviving classes are f and $s + kf$ for a even, and f , $s + kf$ and $2(s + kf)$ for a odd. In particular the product involves no infinite Novikov sum, and the two monomials Q^f and Q^{s+kf} generate every coefficient that occurs. The displayed relations therefore hold in the specialized ring, and the resulting surjection from the presented algebra, which is

free of rank four, onto the specialized quantum cohomology, also free of rank four, is an isomorphism.

The two transported presentations are those of [12, Theorems 9.3.1 and 9.3.3], obtained there by the same identification of the genus-zero theory of F_a with that of $F_{a \bmod 2}$ and, in that paper's generators, by a shift of the section class by a multiple of the fibre class. What the quartic consumes, however, is the presentation of the *specialized* ring over A , and it is the truncation above that makes the transported product finite and identifies the presented algebra with that ring.

The quartic. Specializing along χ and substituting $Q^f \mapsto u$ and $Q^{s+kf} \mapsto w$ in the transported presentation, the specialized small quantum cohomology of F_a is $A[S^b, F]$ modulo $(S^{b^2} - u, F^2 - w)$ for a even and modulo $(S^{b^2} + S^b F - u, F^2 - wS^b)$ for a odd. In the basis $1, F, S^b, S^b F$ the matrix of multiplication by $c_1(T)$ is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 2w & 2u & 0 \\ 2 & 0 & 0 & 2u \\ 2 & 0 & 0 & 2w \\ 0 & 2 & 2 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 2u & wu \\ 3 & 0 & 0 & 2u \\ 2 & 3w & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 1 & -w \end{pmatrix}$$

respectively, and its characteristic polynomial is (5.12). Evaluating the discriminant of a monic quartic on those coefficients gives (5.12). $\square$

Lemma 5.13 (Degeneracy dichotomy of the ruled Euler spectrum). *Keep the notation of Lemma 5.12; strict admissibility makes u and w nonzero. Exactly one of the following holds.*

- (a) $\text{disc } P_a \neq 0$. Equivalently $u \neq w$ for a even and $256u + 27w^2 \neq 0$ for a odd. Then every spectral block of Euler multiplication has rank one.
- (b) $\text{disc } P_a = 0$. Then P_a has exactly one double root and two simple roots, so Euler multiplication has one spectral block of rank two, whose nilpotent part squares to zero, and two blocks of rank one.

No other block shape occurs. By Lemmas 5.11 and 5.14, case (b) does not arise for a center specialization when $a \geq 1$; for F_0 it can, which is why that surface is treated by the product formula in Proposition 5.15.

Proof. By (5.12) and $u, w \neq 0$, the discriminant vanishes exactly on the stated locus. Off it the quartic is separable, so each of its four roots is simple and each maximal generalized eigenspace of Euler multiplication is a line.

On the locus the quartic factors. For a even, $u = w$ gives $P_a = X^2(X^2 - 16u)$, whose double root is 0 and whose two simple roots are the square roots of $16u$, distinct from 0 and from each other. For a odd, write $w = 16\sigma$; then $256u + 27w^2 = 0$ reads $u = -27\sigma^2$ and

$$P_a = (X + 18\sigma)^2 (X^2 - 20\sigma X + 612\sigma^2),$$

whose quadratic factor has the two roots $10\sigma \pm 16\varepsilon$ with $\varepsilon^2 = -2\sigma^2$; these are distinct from each other and from -18σ : a coincidence $10\sigma \pm 16\varepsilon = -18\sigma$ gives $4\varepsilon = \mp 7\sigma$, hence $49\sigma^2 = 16\varepsilon^2 = -32\sigma^2$ and $81\sigma^2 = 0$. In both cases the multiplicity of every root is at most two and the repeated root has multiplicity exactly two. A block of rank two has a single eigenvalue λ , hence trace 2λ and determinant λ^2 ; by Cayley–Hamilton its centered matrix $M - \lambda$ squares to zero. $\square$

Lemma 5.14 (Strictly admissible specializations avoid the degeneracy locus for $a \geq 1$). *Let $T = F_a$ with $a \geq 1$ and let $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ be strictly Novikov-admissible, and graded-monomial if $a = 1$. Then $\text{disc } P_a \neq 0$.*

Proof. Write $p = \ell(f)$ and $r = \ell(s)$; both are positive. Multiplicativity of the valuation and (5.8) give $v(u) = p$ and $v(w) = r + kp$.

Let $a = 2k$ with $k \geq 1$. Then $v(w) = r + kp > p = v(u)$, so $u \neq w$.

Let $a = 2k + 1$ with $k \geq 1$. Then $v(w^2) = 2r + 2kp > p = v(u)$, and a vanishing $256u + 27w^2$ would make $256u = -27w^2$. The integers 256 and 27 are units of A , and negation does not change a valuation, so this forces $v(u) = v(w^2)$, a contradiction.

Let $a = 1$, so $k = 0$ and $v(u) = p$, $v(w^2) = 2r$. If $p \neq 2r$ the previous argument applies. If $p = 2r$, work in the degree- p symbol group. Write $\sigma_p : A_{\geq p} \rightarrow A_{\geq p}/A_{>p}$ for the symbol map, which is additive. Both $256u$ and $27w^2$ have valuation exactly p , so

$$\sigma_p(256u + 27w^2) = 256 \sigma_p(u) + 27 \sigma_p(w^2),$$

and $\sigma_p(u) = \text{gr } \chi(Q^f)$ and $\sigma_p(w^2) = \text{gr } \chi(Q^{2s})$, the second because χ is a monoid map, so $w^2 = \chi(Q^{2s})$. Both are members of the basis B of Definition 5.10, since f and $2s$ are effective. Distinct basis members have no vanishing combination with nonzero coefficients, and equal ones would require $256 + 27 = 0$, so the symbol is nonzero and therefore $256u + 27w^2 \neq 0$. $\square$

Proposition 5.15 (Direct specialized vanishing for rational geometrically ruled centers). *Let $T = F_a$ with $a \geq 0$ and let $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ be strictly Novikov-admissible, and graded-monomial if $a = 1$. Then*

$$\nu_6(T; \chi) = 0.$$

Proof. Let $a = 0$, so $T = \mathbf{P}^1 \times \mathbf{P}^1$; this case is the χ -specialized analogue of Proposition 5.21 below. The Gromov–Witten product formula [7] identifies the small quantum differential module of a product with the tensor product of those of its factors over $\Lambda_{\mathbf{P}^1} \otimes \Lambda_{\mathbf{P}^1} = \Lambda_T$. Every entry of the resulting connection matrix lies in Λ_T , so applying χ entrywise commutes with the identification: the χ -specialized module of T is the tensor product of the modules specialized along the two restrictions of χ to the ruling classes f_1, f_2 . Each factor is a projective line with specialized quantum relation $H^2 = \chi(Q^{f_i})$, and strict admissibility keeps that value nonzero, so by the argument of Proposition 5.9(ii) each factor has simple Euler spectrum and, by Lemma 5.20, trivial framed regular monodromy. As in the proof of Proposition 5.21 below, the Levelt–Turrittin formal decomposition is compatible with tensor products of differential modules, so the framed operator of T is the tensor product of two identities. The argument uses no relation between the two specialized values, which is what the product route buys: χ may identify the two ruling classes, and the discriminant of Lemma 5.12 then vanishes.

Let $a \geq 1$. Lemma 5.14 gives $\text{disc } P_a \neq 0$, so by Lemma 5.13(a) every spectral block of Euler multiplication has rank one, and Lemma 5.20 makes the framed regular monodromy trivial on each. Hence no primitive sixth root occurs. $\square$

Remark 5.16 (Where the tagging hypothesis is still used). Proposition 5.9 shows that Hypothesis 5.7T is not needed for nef-canonical centers, for $\mathbf{P}^1$ or $\mathbf{P}^2$, or—assuming only Hypothesis 5.7R—for ruled surfaces over positive-genus curves, and Proposition 5.15 removes it for the rational geometrically ruled centers as well. Those cases exhaust the minimal surfaces, and also cover F_1 , which is geometrically ruled without being minimal. In the present proof of four-dimensional birational invariance, the substantive use of Hypothesis 5.7T is therefore confined to surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. Every such surface is an iterated point blowup, so eliminating it there would require a separate

support or base-change statement for applying the blowup comparison after the external center specialization; no such statement is assumed here. The quartic of Lemma 5.12 was derived for the Hirzebruch surfaces and is not available for such a center.

Hypothesis 5.7T (Divisor-tagging specialization invariance). *Let $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ be strictly Novikov-admissible. Choose integral divisors $D_1, \dots, D_\rho$ whose pairings separate $N_1(T)$ and define*

$$\chi_t(Q^d) = \chi(Q^d) \exp \left(\sum_i t_i (D_i \cdot d) \right).$$

After passing to algebraic closures of the relevant fraction fields, the intrinsic framed operator of the χ -specialized small connection and the tagged module have the same algebraic multiplicities at $e^{\pi i/3}$ and $e^{-\pi i/3}$.

This hypothesis concerns only the specialization step in this tagging family. It does not assert reconstruction invariance or invariance under an arbitrary divisor-valued bulk deformation.

Lemma 5.17 (Divisor tagging, conditional). *Assume Hypothesis 5.7T. Let $\chi : \Lambda_T \rightarrow A$ be strictly Novikov-admissible. If the intrinsic small even quantum connection of T has no primitive-sixth framed monodromy, neither does its specialization along χ .*

Proof. If $N_1(T) = 0$, then the numerical effective monoid is $\{0\}$, so the coefficient map is already injective and there is nothing to tag. Assume otherwise. Choose integral divisors $D_1, \dots, D_\rho$ whose pairings separate $N_1(T)$, and introduce formal variables $\mathbf{t} = (t_1, \dots, t_\rho)$. Define

$$\chi_t(Q^d) = \chi(Q^d) \exp \left(\sum_i t_i (D_i \cdot d) \right).$$

This formula extends continuously from monomials to the completed Novikov ring. Indeed, strict Novikov admissibility gives $v(\chi(Q^d)) = \ell(d)$, with ℓ positive and proper on the effective numerical monoid. Hence only finitely many classes contribute below any valuation cutoff, so the tagged sum converges coefficientwise in the complete ring $A[[\mathbf{t}]]$ and defines a continuous unital homomorphism. We now prove that it is injective. Take $f = \sum_d c_d Q^d \neq 0$ and put

$$\mu = \min\{v(\chi(Q^d)) : c_d \neq 0\} = \min\{\ell(d) : c_d \neq 0\}, \quad S_\mu = \{d : c_d \neq 0, \ell(d) = \mu\}.$$

Properness in (5.8) makes S_μ finite and nonempty. Write in_v for the initial class in the associated graded. The degree- μ initial form is

$$\text{in}_\mu(\chi_t(f)) = \sum_{d \in S_\mu} c_d \text{in}_v(\chi(Q^d)) \exp \left(\sum_i t_i (D_i \cdot d) \right) \in \text{gr}_v(A)[[\mathbf{t}]],$$

and every displayed summand coefficient is nonzero. Every term outside S_μ has valuation strictly greater than μ , so a nonzero initial form proves $\chi_t(f) \neq 0$. This is a finite combination of distinct exponential characters. The finitely many exponent vectors are distinct integral vectors. Choose $\mathbf{a} = (a_i) \in \mathbf{Z}^\rho$ outside the finitely many integral hyperplanes on which two dot products agree, and substitute $t_i = a_i s$. The resulting exponents are distinct integers. Their derivatives at $s = 0$ form a Vandermonde matrix with nonzero integer determinant, which stays invertible over $\text{Frac}(\text{gr}_v A)$ because that field has characteristic zero. The characters are therefore linearly independent, and the initial form displayed above is nonzero.

The domain hypothesis on $\text{gr}_v(A)$ is used twice, and only twice. It provides the field $\text{Frac}(\text{gr}_v A)$ of the Vandermonde step just made, and it makes v multiplicative on A , since initial forms of nonzero elements then have nonzero product. The valuation of a monomial image is $\ell(d)$ by hypothesis (5.8); multiplicativity is what preserves that value after multiplication by the tag, a unit of valuation zero. Terms with $\ell(d) > \mu$ therefore contribute nothing in degree μ , and each $d \in S_\mu$ contributes its initial form with c_d intact. Were the associated graded to have zero divisors, v would be a filtration rather than a valuation, and the displayed degree- μ identity could fail.

Injectivity of (5) embeds the intrinsic numerical Novikov fraction field into the fraction field of $A[[t]]$, fixing $\mathbf{C}$. Therefore the module obtained by the tagged map is a scalar extension of the intrinsic small module, and their framed characteristic polynomials have the same primitive-sixth multiplicities after passage to a common algebraic closure.

On the other hand, setting $t = 0$ in the tagged family gives the χ -specialized small connection. Hypothesis 5.7T is precisely the remaining assertion that this specialization does not change the two primitive-sixth multiplicities. Combining these two statements proves the lemma. Notice that no pro-Laurent or Hahn-field framed operator is invoked: the hypothesis is attached directly to the specialization step for which it is needed. $\square$

Proposition 5.18 (Low-dimensional vanishing, conditional). *Assume Hypothesis 5.7R, and Hypothesis 5.7T only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. Let T be a point, a smooth projective curve, or a smooth projective surface, and let χ be a strictly Novikov-admissible specialization, graded-monomial when $T \cong F_1$. Then*

$$\nu_6(T; \chi) = 0.$$

Proof. The direct specialized cases are already covered by Proposition 5.9: this includes points and curves of positive genus through the nef-canonical case, the two projective spaces $\mathbf{P}^1, \mathbf{P}^2$, every minimal surface with nef canonical bundle, and, assuming Hypothesis 5.7R, ruled surfaces over positive-genus curves.

The rational geometrically ruled surfaces, that is the Hirzebruch surfaces F_a , are covered by Proposition 5.15, again without Hypothesis 5.7T; the graded-monomial condition on χ is used only there, and only for F_1 . Together these cases cover every minimal surface: a minimal smooth projective surface has nef canonical class, or is $\mathbf{P}^2$, or is geometrically ruled over a curve, by the Enriques–Kodaira classification [6, Chapter VI]. They also cover F_1 , which is geometrically ruled but not minimal.

It remains to treat the surfaces that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. Work intrinsically first, before the external specialization. Every minimal surface has vanishing intrinsic invariant: apply the direct cases just listed to the identity map of Λ_T , which is strictly Novikov-admissible with $\ell = H \cdot (-)$ for an ample H , and graded-monomial because its associated graded is the monoid algebra of the effective monoid, whose monomials are a basis. A surface that is not minimal is obtained from a minimal one by point blowups, and under Hypothesis 5.7R the blowup formula (5.7) adds only point terms, which are zero; so its intrinsic small invariant vanishes as well. For this last case we use Hypothesis 5.7T through Lemma 5.17, which carries the intrinsic vanishing to χ , proving (5.18). $\square$

Theorem 5.19 (Conditional birational invariance through dimension four). *Assume Hypothesis 5.7R, and Hypothesis 5.7T only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. If Y and Y' are birational smooth projective complex varieties of the same dimension at most four, then*

$$\nu_6(Y) = \nu_6(Y').$$

Consequently, for smooth projective threefolds,

$$Y \times \mathbf{P}^1 \dashrightarrow Y' \times \mathbf{P}^1 \implies \nu_6(Y) = \nu_6(Y').$$

Proof. The fold $w_6 : \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{T}_6} \rightarrow \mathbf{N}$ in (5) uses the same occurrence-indexed ledger construction as Section 4. Proposition 5.7 supplies its projective-bundle and blowup laws, including each actual center specialization. Those specializations are strictly Novikov-admissible by the calculation following Definition 5.8 and are graded-monomial by Lemma 5.11. In dimension at most four their centers have dimension at most two, so Proposition 5.18 kills every correction. Theorem 4.2 now gives the first assertion.

If Y, Y' are smooth threefolds and $Y \times \mathbf{P}^1 \dashrightarrow Y' \times \mathbf{P}^1$, apply the first assertion in dimension four and (5.7):

$$2\nu_6(Y) = \nu_6(Y \times \mathbf{P}^1) = \nu_6(Y' \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 2\nu_6(Y').$$

Cancelling two in $\mathbf{N}$ proves the stabilization assertion. $\square$

Lemma 5.20 (Multiplicity-one Euler blocks). *Let T be smooth projective and consider its even quantum connection at an even bulk point over an algebraically closed coefficient field. If a generalized eigenspace of Euler multiplication has rank one, that block contributes only the eigenvalue 1 to framed regular monodromy. In particular, at the small point it contributes nothing to $\nu_6(T)$.*

Proof. Write the horizontal system at the chosen even bulk point in the standard form

$$z^2 \partial_z Y = (U - z\mu)Y,$$

where U is Euler quantum multiplication and μ is the grading operator. The Frobenius property makes U self-adjoint for the Poincaré pairing, while μ is anti-self-adjoint. Generalized eigenspaces belonging to distinct eigenvalues of the self-adjoint operator U are orthogonal, so the pairing restricts nondegenerately to the one-dimensional block. If P is its spectral projector, anti-self-adjointness on this nondegenerate line therefore gives

$$P\mu P = 0.$$

Formally split this line from the other Euler eigenspaces by the normalized gauge $g = I + zg_1 + z^2g_2 + \cdots$ whose positive coefficients are block-off-diagonal. The coefficient of z on the resulting scalar block is

$$-P\mu P + P[U, g_1]P = 0;$$

the logarithmic-derivative term of the gauge begins in order z^2 . Consequently the scalar equation has the form

$$z^2 \partial_z y = (u + z^2 h(z))y, \quad h(z) \in K[[z]],$$

for the corresponding Euler eigenvalue u . Its normalized formal solution is $e^{-u/z}v(z)$ with $v(z) \in 1 + zK[[z]]$. No fractional power of the original loop coordinate and no logarithm occurs, so the framed regular monodromy on this block is the identity. $\square$

Proposition 5.21 (Product with a projective line). *For every smooth projective variety T ,*

$$\nu_6(T \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 2\nu_6(T).$$

This statement is unconditional.

Proof. The product formula for Gromov–Witten theory [7], followed by the numerical Novikov base change of Lemma 5.4, identifies the small numerical quantum connection of $T \times \mathbf{P}^1$ with the tensor-product quantum connection of the two factors. On even cohomology this is simply $H^{\text{ev}}(T) \otimes H^{\text{ev}}(\mathbf{P}^1)$. After adjoining $q^{1/2}$ in the projective-line Novikov coefficient field, quantum multiplication by $c_1(\mathbf{P}^1) = 2H$ has the two distinct eigenvalues

$$2q^{1/2}, \quad -2q^{1/2}.$$

By Lemma 5.20, each corresponding rank-one formal factor has trivial framed regular monodromy. After a common Levelt–Turrittin ramification [29, Chapter 3], the tensor product of factors $\mathcal{E}^\varphi \otimes R$ and $\mathcal{E}^\psi \otimes S$ is $\mathcal{E}^{\varphi+\psi} \otimes (R \otimes S)$. Hence tensoring a formal factor of the quantum differential module of T with one of these rank-one projective-space factors only adds its scalar irregular exponential factor and leaves the original- z -disc regular framed operator of the T factor unchanged. The extension adjoining $q^{1/2}$ is in the coefficient field and is fixed by the z -turn. Consequently the product module has two copies of every framed cyclotomic factor of T , counted with algebraic multiplicity. This gives the formula. $\square$

Corollary 5.22. *The small even framed invariants of the two projective endpoints satisfy*

$$\nu_6(\mathbf{P}^3) = \nu_6(\mathbf{P}^4) = 0.$$

Proof. For $n = 3, 4$, the relation $H^{*(n+1)} = q$ makes multiplication by $(n+1)H$ generically semisimple after adjoining $q^{1/(n+1)}$. Every Euler block has rank one, so Lemma 5.20 gives the claim. $\square$

Proposition 5.23 (The cubic packet). *For every smooth cubic threefold X ,*

$$\nu_6(X) = 2.$$

This proposition is unconditional and uses neither Hypothesis 5.7R nor Hypothesis 5.7T.

Proof. Use the notation of Proposition 4.7 and put $F_X = \overline{\text{Frac } \mathbf{C}[[q]]}$. That proposition separates the small even connection into two scalar blocks and the rank-two zero block (4.14), using only an algebraic Novikov extension and integral powers of the original loop coordinate. We treat the rank-two block first and return to the scalar blocks below.

For the rank-two block, seek a formal solution in the form

$$\tilde{S}_3 = z^\rho(1 + O(z)), \quad \tilde{S}_4 = cz^{\rho+1}(1 + O(z)).$$

The coefficient of $z^{\rho+1}$ in the first coordinate of (4.14), and that of $z^{\rho+2}$ in the second, give respectively

$$\rho = 2c - \frac{19}{18}, \quad c(\rho + 1) = \frac{19}{18}c - \frac{8}{81}.$$

Eliminating c gives

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(\rho + \frac{19}{18} \right) \left(\rho - \frac{1}{18} \right) = -\frac{8}{81}, \quad \text{hence} \quad \rho^2 + \rho + \frac{5}{36} = 0.$$

The quadratic formula applied to (5) gives

$$\rho = -\frac{1}{6}, \quad -\frac{5}{6}.$$

These are the eigenvalues of the modified residue R_X computed in Section 4; their squared difference is $\delta^\sharp(X) = 4/9$. The constant matrix C adjoins only the algebraic Novikov

coefficient r , and (4.16) and its inverse use only integral powers of z . Hence they preserve each exponent class in $\mathbf{Q}/\mathbf{Z}$: multiplication sends $z^\rho F_X[[z]]$ to itself, and the same holds for the inverse. Thus the two classes in (5) remain the classes in the original- z -disc frame. By (5), the framed convention above assigns to a rational exponent ρ the eigenvalue $\text{Exp}_V(\rho) = e^{2\pi i \rho}$. Therefore these two classes give

$$\text{Exp}_V\left(-\frac{1}{6}\right) = e^{-\pi i/3}, \quad \text{Exp}_V\left(-\frac{5}{6}\right) = e^{-5\pi i/3} = e^{\pi i/3}.$$

Put $R = \mathbf{C}[r, r^{-1}]$. The scalar equations have the form $z^2 \partial_z \tilde{S}_\pm = (\pm 6r + h_\pm(z)) \tilde{S}_\pm$, with $h_\pm(z) \in z^2 R[[z]]$. Their normalized formal solutions are

$$\tilde{S}_\pm = e^{\mp 6r/z} u_\pm(z), \quad u_\pm(z) \in 1 + zR[[z]].$$

After removing the exponential, $\partial_z u_\pm = z^{-2} h_\pm(z) u_\pm$ has coefficients in $R[[z]]$, which gives the asserted units. Only integral powers of z occur, so each scalar block is unramified with framed regular-monodromy eigenvalue 1.

It remains to count the rank-two solutions. Write its ansatz as $\tilde{S}_3 = z^\rho \sum_{n \geq 0} a_n z^n$ and $\tilde{S}_4 = z^{\rho+1} \sum_{n \geq 0} b_n z^n$, with $a_0 = 1$. At coefficient n , the two equations have the form

$$L_{\rho+n} \begin{pmatrix} a_n \\ b_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_n \\ \beta_n \end{pmatrix}, \quad L_s = \begin{pmatrix} s + 19/18 & -2 \\ 8/81 & s - 1/18 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \det L_s = \left(s + \frac{1}{6}\right) \left(s + \frac{5}{6}\right).$$

Here (α_n, β_n) depends only on coefficients of lower index; for $n = 0$ it is zero, and (5) is exactly the condition that L_ρ have a kernel. The roots in (5) are distinct modulo $\mathbf{Z}$, so $L_{\rho+n}$ is invertible for every $n \geq 1$. For either root, $\ker L_\rho$ is one-dimensional and its first coordinate is nonzero; the normalization $a_0 = 1$ fixes b_0 . The recursion therefore gives one formal solution for each root and no further solution in its exponent class. The two resulting solutions are independent, and exhaust the rank-two block.

Consequently each eigenvalue in (5) has algebraic multiplicity one, while (5) contributes neither primitive sixth root. Hence

$$\nu_6(X) = 2.$$

No odd-cohomology block enters this small-even calculation, and $N_1(X) = \mathbf{Z}\ell$ makes the numerical Novikov ring $\mathbf{C}[[Q^\ell]] = \mathbf{C}[[q]]$. The proof uses the Beauville-derived reduction of Proposition 4.7 and ordinary formal recursion in the original loop coordinate. It also agrees with Cai's calculation [9, pp. 5–6].

□

Corollary 5.24 (Formal-germ persistence of the cubic packet). *After extending the cubic Novikov coefficient field so that $r = (3q)^{1/2}$ is a unit, the primitive-sixth multiplicity is equal to 2 throughout the formal even bulk germ at the small hyperplane point.*

Proof. At the closed point the Euler eigenvalues are $6r, -6r, 0$, with the zero cluster a single rank-two Jordan block and the two nonzero clusters of rank one. The differences from the zero eigenvalue are units, so Proposition 5.5 applies to the zero packet and freezes its two exponent classes $-1/6, -5/6$. The two simple packets remain rank one on the formal germ and contribute no primitive sixth root by Lemma 5.20. Proposition 5.23 sets the value at the closed point equal to 2. □

Corollary 5.25 (Framed count after one product stabilization). *For every smooth cubic threefold X ,*

$$\nu_6(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 4.$$

This statement is unconditional.

Proof. Combine Proposition 5.21 with Proposition 5.23. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.7. Corollary 5.25 gives $\nu_6(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 4$ unconditionally. Let Y be a rational smooth projective fourfold. Then Y is birational to $\mathbf{P}^4$, so Theorem 5.19 gives $\nu_6(Y) = \nu_6(\mathbf{P}^4) = 0$ by Corollary 5.22. Since $4 \neq 0$, the fourfold $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is not rational. $\square$

This is the framed specialization of the common marker theorem. Its fold is finer, but its operation formulas and birational invariance are conditional. The rank-two formal-exponent fold of Section 4 proves the same irrationality statement without either hypothesis.

5.1 A genus-eight Fano consequence

Kuznetsov associates to every smooth prime Fano threefold V of genus eight a smooth Pfaffian cubic threefold X , together with rank-two vector bundles U on V and E^* on X , whose projectivizations are related by a flop [25, Theorems 2.17–2.18].

Corollary 5.26 (One stabilization of V_{14}). *For every smooth prime Fano threefold V of genus eight,*

$$V \times \mathbf{P}^1 \text{ is irrational.}$$

Assuming Hypothesis 5.7R, and Hypothesis 5.7T only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled, one moreover has

$$\nu_6(V) = 2.$$

Proof. The flop gives a birational map between $\mathbf{P}_V(U)$ and $\mathbf{P}_X(E^*)$. A projective bundle is birational to the product of its base with the corresponding projective space, so $V \times \mathbf{P}^1$ is birational to $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$. The latter is irrational by Theorem 1.1, proving the unconditional assertion.

Assume now Hypothesis 5.7R, and Hypothesis 5.7T only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. Both projectivizations are smooth projective fourfolds. By Theorem 5.19, Proposition 5.7, and Proposition 5.23,

$$2\nu_6(V) = \nu_6(\mathbf{P}_V(U)) = \nu_6(\mathbf{P}_X(E^*)) = 2\nu_6(X) = 4.$$

Hence $\nu_6(V) = 2$. $\square$

The scope of this refinement is exactly one product stabilization. No claim is made here about any further stabilization.

6 The separation theorem

The irrationality input in this section is now unconditional: Theorem 1.1 applies to every smooth cubic threefold. The universal CH_0 -triviality inputs are independent classical or cycle-theoretic statements, and pass to the product by the projective-bundle formula for Chow groups.

Proof of Corollary 1.2. Voisin produces a nonempty countable union of subvarieties of codimension at most three in the moduli space of smooth cubic threefolds along which the primitive minimal class $\Theta^4/4!$ is algebraic, hence along which CH_0 is universally trivial [35, Theorem 4.5 and Lemma 4.6]. The projective-bundle formula supplies universal CH_0 -triviality of the product, and Theorem 1.1 supplies its irrationality. $\square$

Proof of Corollary 1.3. The Fermat equation is a sum of five forms in separated single variables, so [14] gives universal CH_0 -triviality; the projective-bundle formula passes it to the product. Irrationality follows from Theorem 1.1. $\square$

Proof of Corollary 1.4. The cubics of [38, Theorem 3.3] carry unirational parametrizations of degrees two and three, and [38, Corollary 3.5] keeps both degrees on $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$. Parametrizations of coprime degrees give a decomposition of the diagonal and hence universal CH_0 -triviality [38, Section 1]. Theorem 1.1 gives irrationality of $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.5. Corollary 3.6 gives universal CH_0 -triviality of X_b , and the projective-bundle formula gives the same property for $X_b \times \mathbf{P}^1$. Theorem 1.1 proves that this fourfold is irrational. Non-isotriviality follows from the nonconstant intermediate-Jacobian period map on the A_5 -component: Hartlieb proves that the closure of its image is a one-dimensional special subvariety [20, Proposition 5.7]. Finally, Proposition 3.13 shows that every point of this moduli curve except the Fermat point lies outside the separated-variable locus. $\square$

The two mechanisms are independent without any standing hypothesis. On the cycle side, algebraicity of $\Theta^4/4!$ removes the universal- CH_0 obstruction. On the quantum side, the rank-two formal-exponent marker has value 1 on a cubic threefold and vanishes on every possible center in a factorization of fourfolds; the categorical ledger therefore obstructs rationality after one product stabilization. The special A_5 -geometry enters only in the cycle argument, whereas the QDM marker applies to every smooth cubic threefold. The cycle construction also shows, by Proposition 3.13, that away from the Fermat point its universal CH_0 -triviality is not explained by the separated-variable criterion.

The framed invariant ν_6 is a finer, partially conditional instance of the same categorical ledger theorem, using a block type that also retains the small section and original loop framing. Its values $\nu_6(X) = 2$ and $\nu_6(X \times \mathbf{P}^1) = 4$ are unconditional for every smooth cubic threefold by Proposition 5.23 and Corollary 5.25. Hypothesis 5.7R is used only for the residual reconstruction-tail step in the operation formulas. The direct specialization arguments of Propositions 5.9 and 5.15 remove Hypothesis 5.7T for nef-canonical targets, $\mathbf{P}^1$, $\mathbf{P}^2$, every rational geometrically ruled surface (for F_1 , on the specializations that arise as blowup centers), and, assuming 5.7R, ruled surfaces over positive-genus curves; 5.7T remains only for surface centers that are neither minimal nor geometrically ruled. Conditional on 5.7R and on 5.7T for those centers, the common marker theorem makes ν_6 birationally invariant through dimension four. Neither hypothesis is a condition on any separation statement in this section.

For comparison, the two threefold-level quantities are logically independent. If $U(Y)$ denotes the indicator of universal CH_0 -triviality, Corollary 5.22 gives $\nu_6(\mathbf{P}^3) = 0$ unconditionally, while Proposition 5.23 gives $\nu_6 = 2$ for every cubic. Consequently

$$(U(Y), \nu_6(Y)) = \begin{cases} (1, 0), & Y = \mathbf{P}^3, \\ (1, 2), & Y \text{ is a smooth member of the } A_5\text{-family,} \\ (0, 2), & Y \text{ is a very general cubic threefold.} \end{cases}$$

Voisin's criterion [35, Corollary 4.4] and the evenness theorem [15, Theorem 1.3 and Corollary 1.4] give the last line. Thus neither universal CH_0 -triviality nor ν_6 determines the other.

All stabilization statements in this paper concern $X \times \mathbf{P}^1$. No claim about further stabilization is implicit in the theorem above.

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